

ENGLISH FOR QUALITY ASSURANCE AND SOFTWARE TESTING

Software Quality & Testing English

Clear findings. Useful next checks.



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Eight scenarios. Eight extended conversations.

INSIDE THE BOOK

192 vocabulary entries / 128 reusable phrases

160 dialogue turns / 80 numbered dialogue gaps

Word banks and explained answer keys

Upper-intermediate to advanced (B2-C1). For software testers, quality analysts, automation engineers, and test leads discussing requirements, defects, coverage, and release evidence.

2026 edition

Eight scenarios. Eight skills.

Eight testing conversations build precise reporting and productive challenge: expected results, reproduction, boundary cases, change risk, inconsistent automation, triage, exploratory findings, and release handovers.

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02 Making a failure reproducible

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A result is only as clear as its boundary.

A passing test does not cover an untested path. A blocked check is not a pass. An unexpected behavior may expose a missing requirement rather than a confirmed violation. Good testing English keeps those distinctions visible.

Agree what correct means

Conflicting examples cannot both define the same expected result. Name the exact equality case and ask the requirement owner to resolve it. Do not allow a test script to silently become the product rule.

"One example accepts exactly twenty-four hours and another rejects it. Which result is intended?"

Report the conditions with the result

Include the build, saved input, action, actual output, and observed frequency. A successful attempt using different input does not refute a failure under the reported conditions. Keep the scope of the evidence explicit.

"On Q12, this three-item selection omitted the last item in both attempts."

Keep impact and timing separate

A visible error may deserve urgent attention before a demonstration, while a less frequent data defect has a different functional impact. Explain both dimensions without inventing a severity rating, priority decision, or release approval.

"The typo affects every account page; the export defect loses a row in the monthly workflow."

Distinguish untested from successful

A release summary should show passes, failures, blocked checks, unresolved criteria, and decision ownership. Percentages can conceal an unexecuted critical path. A report supports the release decision; it does not replace the authorized decision maker.

"Seven passed, one failed, and two are blocked; one blocked check is critical."

PROFESSIONAL BOUNDARIES

All products, builds, requirements, observations, and decisions are fictional. This book teaches workplace English, not certification content or a complete testing method. Actual requirements, test policies, evidence standards, privacy safeguards, and release authority take precedence. The exercises authorize no live-system changes. A proposed check has no result until executed, and an observed result applies only to its stated conditions.

Exactly twenty-four hours: accept or reject?

A Read the situation

Expose contradictory examples and obtain a clear equality rule without inventing a missing requirement.

A fictional booking requirement says cancellation is allowed within 24 hours. One example permits cancellation exactly 24 hours before the event; another rejects it. Tester Maya and requirement owner Dev review the conflict. The equality case has not been settled. Time-zone handling is outside this discussion. Maya needs an agreed expected result before using a test to declare this exact boundary behavior correct or defective.

PEOPLE / Maya: Tester | Dev: Requirement owner

A PRECISE QUESTION IS NOT OBSTRUCTION

When a phrase supports different readings, identify the exact case rather than asking whether the entire requirement is clear. Two contradictory examples provide a concrete reason to seek a decision. Keep your own preferred interpretation separate from the agreed rule.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which case is contradictory?

- A** Cancellation exactly 24 hours before the event
- B** Every cancellation more than a week ahead
- C** Only time-zone conversion
- D** Every completed booking

2. Who can clarify the intended rule?

- A** An unrelated customer
- B** The test framework
- C** The requirement owner
- D** The test result alone

3. What is outside this discussion?

- A** The equality case
- B** The contradictory examples
- C** The expected cancellation result
- D** Time-zone handling

[Answers and explanations: page 76.](#)

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

requirement

Statement of behavior or capability the product should provide.

IN USE clarify the requirement

expected result

Outcome a test should produce under the agreed rule.

IN USE agree the expected result

actual result

Outcome observed when the test is executed.

IN USE record the actual result

acceptance criterion

Condition used to judge whether a requirement is met.

IN USE refine the acceptance criterion

ambiguity

Wording that permits more than one interpretation.

IN USE resolve an ambiguity

contradiction

Two statements that cannot both hold for the same case.

IN USE identify a contradiction

boundary

Point where an applicable rule or outcome changes.

IN USE test the boundary

equality case

Input exactly equal to the specified threshold.

IN USE clarify the equality case

inclusive limit

Limit that includes the endpoint itself.

IN USE specify an inclusive limit

exclusive limit

Limit that excludes the endpoint itself.

IN USE distinguish an exclusive limit

threshold

Value at which a rule changes or applies.

IN USE name the threshold

test oracle

Reference used to decide the expected outcome.

IN USE establish the test oracle

Precision check

The exact twenty-four-hour case has two conflicting expected outcomes. Neither the word within nor the current implementation resolves that conflict by itself. Request an explicit accept-or-reject decision for equality.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

test basis

Information from which tests and expectations are derived.

IN USE review the test basis

example

Concrete instance illustrating a rule.

IN USE reconcile conflicting examples

business rule

Product behavior specified for a business purpose.

IN USE confirm the business rule

requirement owner

Person responsible for clarifying the relevant requirement.

IN USE consult the requirement owner

decision record

Traceable statement of an agreed decision.

IN USE preserve the decision record

assumption

Belief used without current confirmation.

IN USE label an assumption

precondition

State required before a test action is performed.

IN USE state the precondition

postcondition

State expected after the relevant action.

IN USE define the postcondition

traceability

Ability to link a test or result to its supporting requirement.

IN USE maintain traceability

scope boundary

Limit on topics or behavior covered by the work.

IN USE respect the scope boundary

pass/fail judgment

Conclusion comparing observed behavior with an agreed expectation.

IN USE defer the pass/fail judgment

clarification request

Specific question seeking missing or inconsistent information.

IN USE raise a clarification request

Precision check

Do not confuse a requirement decision with an observed result. The owner defines intended behavior; testing then compares behavior with that rule. Leave time-zone handling outside this focused discussion rather than inventing a policy.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

LOCATE THE AMBIGUITY

"The two examples disagree at exactly twenty-four hours."

NAME THE SECOND OUTCOME

"The other rejects the same case."

SEPARATE PREFERENCE

"My interpretation is not yet an agreed rule."

AVOID AN IMPLEMENTATION SHORTCUT

"Current behavior does not settle intended behavior."

NAME THE FIRST OUTCOME

"One example allows the cancellation."

ASK THE PRECISE QUESTION

"Should equality be accepted or rejected?"

REQUEST AUTHORITY

"Can the requirement owner clarify this point?"

REQUEST A USABLE EXPECTATION

"We need one expected result for this input."

Exactly

Focuses the question on equality rather than a nearby value.

The same case

Makes the contradiction explicit.

Should ... or

Requests a choice without choosing on the owner's behalf.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

NAME THE BOUNDARY

"I am asking about the endpoint itself."

KEEP SCOPE FOCUSED

"Time-zone handling is outside this discussion."

REQUEST ALIGNMENT

"Please update the conflicting example after the decision."

PRESERVE TRACEABILITY

"Link the test to the clarified requirement."

DEFER JUDGMENT

"I cannot make a justified pass/fail judgment on this case yet."

AVOID PREMATURE AGREEMENT

"The equality rule remains unresolved."

CONFIRM THE DECISION STATUS

"This is a clarification request, not a chosen outcome."

CLOSE WITH THE NEXT STEP

"Record the intended result before finalizing the test expectation."

Not yet

Preserves the unresolved status of an interpretation.

By itself

Limits what an ambiguous phrase or implementation can establish.

After the decision

Keeps the sequence of clarification and test update clear.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which question is most precise?

- A** Can we ignore both examples?
- B** Should every booking be deleted?
- C** At exactly 24 hours before the event, should cancellation be accepted or rejected?
- D** Is the feature generally good?

2. What should serve as the test expectation?

- A** Whatever the code currently does
- B** A different product's behavior
- C** The explicitly clarified requirement
- D** The tester's unrecorded preference

3. Which status is accurate now?

- A** Equality remains unresolved
- B** Equality is confirmed accepted
- C** Equality is confirmed rejected
- D** Time zones have been fully tested

4. What should follow clarification?

- A** Align the examples and link the test to the decision
- B** Keep contradictory examples as equal authorities
- C** Erase all requirement history
- D** Claim every cancellation case passed

[Answers and explanations: page 76.](#)

Exactly twenty-four hours: accept or reject?

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

equality case / contradiction / test oracle / inclusive limit / scope boundary / assumption / traceability / pass/fail judgment / decision record / clarification request

- 01 **Maya:** I need a clarification before I finalize the cancellation test. The requirement says within twenty-four hours, but the examples disagree about exactly twenty-four hours before the event.
- 02 **Dev:** Show me the ¹ _____ you are comparing. I want to separate that exact endpoint from any other timing question before we decide what the rule should mean.
- 03 **Maya:** One example permits cancellation at that exact point. The other rejects it. They describe the same timing condition, so I cannot use both as the expected result.
- 04 **Dev:** That is a real ² _____, not merely a difference in wording. We need to resolve the intended outcome rather than ask you to choose whichever example matches the implementation.
- 05 **Maya:** My first reading was that the endpoint would be included. I have kept that as my interpretation, not entered it as an approved rule.
- 06 **Dev:** Good. Label it an ³ _____ until the requirement decision is explicit. Your reading may be reasonable, but it is not enough to declare the product correct or defective.
- 07 **Maya:** The question I need answered is narrow: should cancellation exactly twenty-four hours before the event be accepted or rejected? I am not asking about time-zone conversion here.
- 08 **Dev:** That keeps the ⁴ _____ clear. We should not introduce a separate timing policy into this discussion and then mistake that for resolving the original conflict.
- 09 **Maya:** Could we simply take the current application result as authoritative? It would let me finish the test, but it would also make the test copy the implementation.
- 10 **Dev:** That would not establish the ⁵ _____. We need the intended rule first, otherwise the test can repeat an existing mistake and still appear to pass.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 10.

- 11 **Maya:** Once the decision is recorded, I can update the expected result and identify which example needs correction. Until then, the test expectation remains open.
- 12 **Dev:** Yes. The ⁶ _____ should state the endpoint behavior explicitly. A vague note saying clarified would leave the same interpretation problem for the next tester.
- 13 **Maya:** I will avoid writing inclusive until the owner actually chooses that rule. The alternative would exclude the endpoint, and the current examples support both readings.
- 14 **Dev:** Exactly. An ⁷ _____ is one possible decision, not a fact we have already agreed. Keep the options separate from the final rule.
- 15 **Maya:** The issue can include both examples and the single equality question. That should make it easy to answer without reopening every aspect of cancellation.
- 16 **Dev:** That is a useful ⁸ _____. It gives the requirement owner a concrete choice and shows why testing cannot make a justified judgment yet.
- 17 **Maya:** When the clarification arrives, I will link it to the test and align the examples. I will not change the old example silently and lose the reason.
- 18 **Dev:** Preserve that ⁹ _____. Anyone reviewing the result should be able to see which rule was applied and why it replaced the conflicting interpretation.
- 19 **Maya:** For now, my status is equality unresolved, expected result pending clarification, and time-zone handling outside this discussion. I have not chosen accept or reject.
- 20 **Dev:** That is accurate. Defer the ¹⁰ _____ for this case until the intended outcome is recorded. The next step is a requirement decision, not an invented test result.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 77

1. equality case | 2. contradiction | 3. assumption | 4. scope boundary | 5. test oracle | 6. decision record | 7. inclusive limit | 8. clarification request | 9. traceability | 10. pass/fail judgment

Ask one answerable requirement question

F Say it

Complete the clarification exchange without choosing the unresolved cancellation outcome.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

result / 24 / discussion / unresolved

Tester: "The examples conflict at exactly ¹ _____ hours."

Owner: "The equality case remains ² _____."

Tester: "The test needs an agreed expected ³ _____."

Owner: "Time-zone handling is outside this ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 77

1. 24 | 2. unresolved | 3. result | 4. discussion

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Three selected, two exported, twice

A Read the situation

Give a reproducible defect report and explain why a successful attempt with different input does not disprove it.

On fictional build Q12, tester Hana exports a saved selection of three items. The output omits the last selected item. She observes the omission in two attempts out of two. Developer Joel exports one item successfully. No other build or selection size has been checked. They compare conditions and prepare a handoff using the saved three-item selection, the export action, and the observed output without claiming every export fails.

PEOPLE / Hana: Tester reporting the omission | Joel: Developer investigating the report

DIFFERENT RESULTS MAY COME FROM DIFFERENT CONDITIONS

Cannot reproduce can sound like dismissal if the input is not compared. State the successful attempt accurately, then ask for the reported fixture. A bounded reproduction frequency is more useful than always or sometimes without a denominator.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which build did Hana test?

A Q20

C An unspecified previous build

B Every release

D Q12

2. What did Joel successfully export?

A Every selection size

C One item

B The omitted item in every build

D The same saved three-item selection

3. What frequency is established?

A Two omissions in two attempts with the saved selection

C One failure in ten attempts

B Every export always fails

D No repeatable omission

Answers and explanations: page 78.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

defect report

Record describing a suspected or confirmed product problem.

IN USE submit a defect report

build identifier

Label identifying the software version under test.

IN USE include the build identifier

reproduction steps

Ordered actions used to observe a reported problem.

IN USE follow the reproduction steps

saved selection

Retained set of items used as input.

IN USE reuse the saved selection

test fixture

Prepared data or state for a test.

IN USE share the test fixture

actual output

Data or behavior produced by the executed operation.

IN USE attach the actual output

expected output

Data or behavior required for the test to pass.

IN USE state the expected output

omission

Absence of something that should be included.

IN USE report the final-item omission

selection size

Number of items included in the chosen input.

IN USE compare selection size

reproduction frequency

Observed failures relative to stated attempts and conditions.

IN USE report reproduction frequency

denominator

Total count against which a proportion is measured.

IN USE state the denominator

environment detail

Relevant setting or configuration for an observation.

IN USE preserve environment details

Precision check

Two out of two describes Hana's observed attempts with the saved three-item selection on Q12. It is not a universal failure rate for every input, every session, or every build.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

attachment

Supporting file included with a report.

IN USE add an attachment

evidence bundle

Group of supporting records for an investigation.

IN USE prepare an evidence bundle

screen recording

Recorded visual sequence of an interaction.

IN USE attach a screen recording

log excerpt

Relevant portion of recorded system events.

IN USE include a log excerpt

minimal reproduction

Smallest useful example retaining the observed problem.

IN USE seek a minimal reproduction

counterexample

Example contradicting a universal claim under its relevant terms.

IN USE assess a counterexample

scope of evidence

Range of conditions actually supported by observations.

IN USE limit the scope of evidence

unverified condition

Condition whose behavior has not been checked.

IN USE identify an unverified condition

confirmation run

Repeat intended to check the reported behavior.

IN USE perform a confirmation run

input parity

Use of matching input in a comparison.

IN USE establish input parity

cannot reproduce

Status indicating failure to observe the report under stated attempts.

IN USE qualify cannot reproduce

handoff note

Concise record transferring evidence and next steps.

IN USE prepare the handoff note

Precision check

Joel's one-item success is compatible with Hana's report because the input differs. Reuse the saved selection before deciding whether the original failure can be reproduced. Do not invent results for untested selection sizes.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

IDENTIFY THE BUILD

"I observed this on Q12."

STATE THE ACTION

"I exported that selection."

REPORT FREQUENCY

"It occurred in two attempts out of two."

ACKNOWLEDGE THE COMPARISON

"Your one-item attempt succeeded."

IDENTIFY THE INPUT

"I used the saved selection of three items."

STATE THE OMISSION

"The last selected item is missing from the output."

LIMIT THE CLAIM

"I have not tested other builds."

EXPLAIN THE DIFFERENCE

"That uses a different selection size."

Out of

Supplies the denominator for the observed frequency.

On Q12

Restricts the observation to the named build.

The same

Requests matched input rather than a vaguely similar attempt.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

REQUEST MATCHING INPUT

"Please use the same saved selection."

REQUEST EVIDENCE

"I will attach the selection and actual output."

NAME AN UNKNOWN

"Other selection sizes remain unchecked."

REQUEST CONFIRMATION

"Report the result with the same input and build."

AVOID DISMISSAL

"The one-item result does not disprove this report."

KEEP STEPS REPEATABLE

"Follow the recorded action sequence."

AVOID OVERGENERALIZING

"I am not claiming that every export fails."

CLOSE THE HANDOFF

"The report includes the conditions, omission, and observed frequency."

Does not disprove

Explains why a different successful case can coexist with the report.

Have not tested

Keeps an evidence gap explicit.

Not claiming every

Corrects an overgeneralization without weakening the actual observation.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which title best preserves the evidence?

- A** Q12 export omits last item from saved three-item selection, observed twice
- B** All exports always lose data
- C** Export fails on every build
- D** One-item exports are broken

2. Why does Joel's result not refute Hana's?

- A** Successful tests never matter
- B** Q12 cannot export anything
- C** Hana tested every possible input
- D** The selection size differs

3. Which next attempt is most directly relevant?

- A** Use an unrelated build and ten new items
- B** Change all settings at once
- C** Repeat only the one-item test
- D** Use Q12 and the same saved three-item selection

4. Which claim is unsupported?

- A** Other builds are unchecked
- B** Every selection size is affected
- C** The last item was omitted twice
- D** Joel's one-item attempt succeeded

Answers and explanations: [page 78](#).

Three selected, two exported, twice

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

cannot reproduce / scope of evidence / input parity / actual output / confirmation run / minimal reproduction / evidence bundle / build identifier / defect report / denominator

- 01 **Hana:** I have an export issue on Q12. With the saved selection of three items, the output omits the last selected item. I observed it in both attempts.
- 02 **Joel:** My one-item export succeeded, so I initially marked it ¹ _____. I should compare the input before treating that result as a response to your report.
- 03 **Hana:** Yes. I am not saying every export fails. The evidence concerns this three-item selection on Q12, and I have not checked other builds or sizes.
- 04 **Joel:** Let us establish ² _____. Can you attach the saved selection so I can use the exact same items rather than create a roughly similar example?
- 05 **Hana:** I can include that and the exported output. The important difference is that the final selected item is absent, not that the entire export is empty.
- 06 **Joel:** That makes the ³ _____ clear. The report should distinguish a partial omission from a completely failed operation because those observations suggest different investigation paths.
- 07 **Hana:** For frequency, I will write two attempts out of two. I do not want the shorthand always to sound like I have tried many inputs.
- 08 **Joel:** Good. State the ⁴ _____ and conditions together. Two repeat observations are useful, but they do not justify a universal claim about all exports.
- 09 **Hana:** Would my second attempt count as confirmation that the saved selection reproduces the issue? It gave the same missing final item, with no build change.
- 10 **Joel:** It is a ⁵ _____ under those stated conditions. Keep that fact separate from any claim that you have isolated the internal cause.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 19.

- 11 **Hana:** I have no evidence yet about why the item disappears. The report can remain useful without naming a loop error or a particular component.
- 12 **Joel:** Exactly. A ⁶ _____ needs clear behavior and supporting evidence; it does not require you to guess the implementation defect.
- 13 **Hana:** I will include the build label at the top, then the saved selection, the export action, and a comparison showing the missing item.
- 14 **Joel:** The ⁷ _____ is important. If I use a different build, I need to report that difference rather than merge the outcomes as though the conditions matched.
- 15 **Hana:** Your one-item success should stay in the discussion too. It is a real observation, just not the same test as mine.
- 16 **Joel:** Agreed. It narrows the ⁸ _____, and we should preserve it. Different results can coexist when the input differs; neither needs to be erased to make the report coherent.
- 17 **Hana:** If you later reduce the three-item selection while keeping the omission, please record exactly which input still fails. We do not yet know the smallest failing example.
- 18 **Joel:** That would help find a ⁹ _____. For now, the known reproducer is your saved selection, and I should start there rather than assume another size behaves the same.
- 19 **Hana:** My handoff will attach that selection and output, name Q12, state two out of two, and list other builds and selection sizes as unchecked.
- 20 **Joel:** That is a usable ¹⁰ _____. I will run the reported conditions and return the actual result, not repeat the broader cannot-reproduce label without its limits.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 79

1. cannot reproduce | 2. input parity | 3. actual output | 4. denominator | 5. confirmation run | 6. defect report | 7. build identifier | 8. scope of evidence | 9. minimal reproduction | 10. evidence bundle

Report a bounded reproduction

F Say it

Complete the report using only the observed build, input, output, and frequency.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

last / Q12 / three / two

Tester: "The tested build is ¹ _____."

Developer: "The saved selection contains ² _____ items."

Tester: "The ³ _____ selected item is omitted."

Developer: "The omission occurred in ⁴ _____ attempts out of two."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 79

1. Q12 | 2. three | 3. last | 4. two

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Five, ten, and fifteen never touch the limits

A Read the situation

Explain missing boundary and rejection coverage while keeping unspecified decimal behavior separate from the whole-number rule.

A fictional quantity form accepts whole numbers from 1 through 20 inclusive and rejects whole-number values outside that range. The proposed tests use only 5, 10, and 15. Tester Rosa and developer Amir review the gap. They propose boundary-focused values 0, 1, 2, 19, 20, and 21. Decimal handling is unspecified and outside the stated whole-number rule. The new tests are proposed, not executed results.

PEOPLE / Rosa: Tester reviewing case selection | Amir: Developer discussing the rule

EXPLAIN WHY A CASE MATTERS

Adding more inputs is less persuasive than connecting each input to a rule. Name the accepted endpoint, its nearby accepted neighbor, and the adjacent rejected value. Keep a missing decimal rule visible without silently expanding the product specification.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which whole-number values are accepted by the rule?

- A 0 through 20 inclusive
- C Every positive number

- B 1 through 19 only
- D 1 through 20 inclusive

2. What is missing from 5, 10, and 15?

- A A confirmed decimal policy
- C All accepted values

- B Endpoint and outside-range checks
- D The existence of a quantity field

3. What is known about decimals?

- A They are rounded automatically
- C They are all accepted

- B Handling is unspecified
- D They are all rejected under an explicit rule

Answers and explanations: [page 80](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

boundary value

Input at an edge where a rule changes.

IN USE select a boundary value

boundary value analysis

Test design concentrating on rule edges and nearby values.

IN USE apply boundary value analysis

equivalence partition

Group of inputs expected to follow the same relevant rule.

IN USE identify an equivalence partition

valid partition

Input group accepted under the specified rule.

IN USE sample the valid partition

invalid partition

Input group rejected under the specified rule.

IN USE cover an invalid partition

lower bound

Smallest value within a defined range.

IN USE check the lower bound

upper bound

Largest value within a defined range.

IN USE check the upper bound

inclusive range

Range containing both stated endpoints.

IN USE specify an inclusive range

whole number

Number without a fractional part in the stated quantity context.

IN USE enter a whole number

adjacent value

Nearest relevant value beside a boundary.

IN USE test the adjacent value

interior value

Input strictly between the relevant endpoints.

IN USE distinguish an interior value

off-by-one error

Mistake that shifts a count or boundary by one unit.

IN USE detect an off-by-one error

Precision check

One and twenty are accepted endpoints. Zero and twenty-one are adjacent rejected whole-number values. Two and nineteen check just inside the range. The existing five, ten, and fifteen do not test these edges.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

acceptance region

Set of inputs the stated rule accepts.

IN USE define the acceptance region

rejection region

Set of inputs the stated rule rejects.

IN USE cover the rejection region

input domain

Set of inputs relevant to the defined problem.

IN USE state the input domain

decimal input

Input containing a fractional numeric value.

IN USE clarify decimal input

validation message

User-facing message explaining an input condition.

IN USE check the validation message

test case

Defined input, action, and expected outcome for a check.

IN USE specify the test case

case selection

Choice of checks to cover relevant behavior.

IN USE explain case selection

coverage item

Rule, value, or condition counted in a coverage assessment.

IN USE identify the coverage item

decision rule

Condition-to-outcome relationship.

IN USE map the decision rule

decision table

Organized mapping of condition combinations to outcomes.

IN USE build a decision table

out-of-range value

Input below or above the accepted range.

IN USE reject an out-of-range value

unspecified behavior

Behavior for which no governing rule is supplied.

IN USE flag unspecified behavior

Precision check

Keep rule-based expectations separate from execution results: the proposed cases should accept or reject as stated, but no new test has yet been run. Decimal handling needs its own requirement clarification rather than an invented rounding or rejection rule.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

03

STATE THE DOMAIN

"The rule concerns whole-number quantities."

STATE THE RANGE

"One through twenty are accepted, including both endpoints."

DESCRIBE EXISTING CASES

"Five, ten, and fifteen are interior values."

NAME THE LOWER ENDPOINT

"One should be accepted."

NAME THE VALUE BELOW

"Zero should be rejected."

NAME THE UPPER ENDPOINT

"Twenty should be accepted."

NAME THE VALUE ABOVE

"Twenty-one should be rejected."

ADD INSIDE NEIGHBORS

"Two and nineteen check just inside the limits."

Through ... inclusive

Includes both endpoints in the accepted range.

Should be

States a rule-derived expectation rather than an observed result.

Just inside

Identifies the accepted neighbor near a boundary.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

03

EXPLAIN THE GAP

"The current set never reaches either boundary."

AVOID A RESULT CLAIM

"These are expected outcomes, not completed test results."

AVOID INVENTING ROUNDING

"We have no agreed rounding rule."

KEEP COVERAGE HONEST

"Boundary cases improve coverage but do not prove the form defect-free."

CONNECT CASE AND RULE

"Each added value tests a specific edge condition."

SEPARATE DECIMALS

"Decimal handling is not specified."

REQUEST CLARIFICATION

"Ask for the decimal policy separately."

CLOSE THE PROPOSAL

"Add the six boundary-focused cases and retain their expected outcomes."

Below versus above

Separates the two rejected regions.

Not specified

Marks missing requirements without choosing a behavior.

Improve ... but

Recognizes a benefit while limiting the coverage claim.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which six-value set checks both endpoints and their immediate neighbors?

- A** 5, 6, 10, 11, 14, 15
- B** 1, 5, 10, 15, 18, 19
- C** 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7
- D** 0, 1, 2, 19, 20, 21

2. Which expected result is correct?

- A** Accept both 0 and 21
- B** Reject every interior value
- C** Accept 20 and reject 21
- D** Reject 20 and accept 21

3. Which decimal statement is justified?

- A** Decimals are already tested
- B** The rule requires clarification for decimals
- C** All decimals round down
- D** Every decimal is explicitly rejected

4. Which coverage claim is appropriate?

- A** The proposed set addresses the missing edges but has not been executed
- B** All possible defects are eliminated
- C** Three interior checks prove both bounds
- D** The new cases have already passed

Answers and explanations: [page 80](#).

Five, ten, and fifteen never touch the limits

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

invalid partition / decimal input / coverage / decision table / boundary value analysis / adjacent value / boundary value / Case selection / expected result / inclusive range

- 01 **Rosa:** The proposed quantity tests use five, ten, and fifteen. They are all accepted values, but none checks the point where acceptance changes to rejection.
- 02 **Amir:** You mean the ¹ _____ cases at one and twenty. The requirement says both endpoints are included, so those exact values should be accepted.
- 03 **Rosa:** Yes. We should also check zero below the lower endpoint and twenty-one above the upper endpoint. Both are outside the accepted whole-number range.
- 04 **Amir:** That gives us an ² _____ on either side. The existing tests only sample the accepted middle and tell us nothing about either rejection region.
- 05 **Rosa:** I propose zero, one, two, nineteen, twenty, and twenty-one. That includes each endpoint and the nearest whole number on both sides.
- 06 **Amir:** The ³ _____ matters because a comparison can be wrong by one. Checking only five would not expose an error that rejects one but accepts the rest.
- 07 **Rosa:** Two and nineteen are still valid, but they check just inside the limits. I want to explain their role so the extra cases do not look arbitrary.
- 08 **Amir:** That is a clear use of ⁴ _____. Connect each proposed input to its expected result and the edge condition it helps examine.
- 09 **Rosa:** For the lower end, zero should be rejected, while one and two should be accepted. We have not run those new cases yet.
- 10 **Amir:** Keep that ⁵ _____ language. Saying should be accepted follows the requirement; saying passed would falsely imply an observation we do not have.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

03

Continue with the word bank on page 28.

- 11 **Rosa:** At the upper end, nineteen and twenty should be accepted, while twenty-one should be rejected. The word inclusive is doing important work here.
- 12 **Amir:** Exactly. An ⁶ _____ includes the endpoints themselves. We should not quietly turn twenty into the first rejected value.
- 13 **Rosa:** A colleague asked about one point five. The current rule is about whole numbers, and no decimal policy is stated.
- 14 **Amir:** Then ⁷ _____ needs a separate clarification. We should not invent rounding, truncation, acceptance, or rejection and present it as an existing requirement.
- 15 **Rosa:** Could the decision table keep the whole-number regions separate: below one, one through twenty, and above twenty? That would show which rule each case represents.
- 16 **Amir:** Yes. A ⁸ _____ can organize those outcomes. Mark decimal behavior as unspecified rather than folding it into a rejection rule that was never agreed.
- 17 **Rosa:** I will retain the interior tests where useful, but I will not use their count as proof that the limits are covered. Three tests can still miss both edges.
- 18 **Amir:** Correct. ⁹ _____ is about the conditions exercised, not simply having several numbers in a list. The current values all occupy the interior.
- 19 **Rosa:** The revised proposal will list the six boundary-focused cases and their expectations. It will say they are planned and that decimal handling remains unresolved.
- 20 **Amir:** That is accurate ¹⁰ _____ language. It improves the design while keeping both execution status and the missing decimal rule visible to the team.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 81

1. boundary value | 2. invalid partition | 3. adjacent value | 4. boundary value analysis | 5. expected result | 6. inclusive range | 7. decimal input | 8. decision table | 9. Case selection | 10. coverage

Read the limits literally

F Say it

Complete the expected-result exchange. These expectations come from the stated rule, not from completed test runs.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

21 / unspecified / 20 / 1

Tester: "The accepted lower endpoint is ¹ _____."

Developer: "The accepted upper endpoint is ² _____."

Tester: "The whole number immediately above the range is ³ _____."

Developer: "Decimal handling remains ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 81

1. 1 | 2. 20 | 3. 21 | 4. unspecified

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

The account page opens; the changed paths are unchecked

04

A Read the situation

Explain limited smoke-test evidence and justify focused follow-up on both consumers of a changed formatter.

A fictional account update passes a smoke test that signs in and opens the account page. The update changes a formatter used by account-save and by the existing export path. Neither of those paths has been tested. Tester Elena and team lead Sam have one hour for further checking. They need to prioritize evidence around the shared change without claiming full coverage or assuming the existing export path is unaffected.

PEOPLE / Elena: Tester | Sam: Team lead

REPLACE TESTED WITH NAMED PATHS

A short status such as smoke passed can be useful if everyone knows its limits. Name what ran, then connect the changed component to its consumers. A time limit calls for explicit priorities and residual risk, not a larger claim about the same narrow evidence.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What did the smoke test cover?

A All regression checks

C Account-save and export

B Sign-in and opening the account page

D Every formatter consumer

2. Which paths use the changed formatter?

A Account-save and existing export

C Export only

B Sign-in only

D No existing behavior

3. How much time remains?

A Two completed test cycles

C A full week

B One hour

D No time limit

Answers and explanations: page 82.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

smoke test

Small check set used to detect major basic failures.

IN USE pass the smoke test

regression testing

Checking existing behavior for problems introduced by change.

IN USE prioritize regression testing

change impact

Potential effect of a modification on related behavior.

IN USE assess change impact

shared component

Component used by more than one path or feature.

IN USE identify the shared component

formatter

Component converting values into a required representation.

IN USE trace formatter usage

consumer path

Execution route using a shared component.

IN USE test the consumer path

account-save path

Route that persists an account update.

IN USE exercise the account-save path

export path

Route producing output for external use.

IN USE check the export path

coverage gap

Relevant behavior not yet checked.

IN USE report the coverage gap

risk-based testing

Selection of tests according to relevant likelihood and impact concerns.

IN USE propose risk-based testing

test priority

Relative order or urgency assigned to checks.

IN USE set test priority

timebox

Fixed amount of time allocated to work.

IN USE use a one-hour timebox

Precision check

Opening the account page does not establish correct account-save formatting, and it does not exercise export. Both use the changed formatter. Existing behavior can need regression checking even when the visible update is described as an account change.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

residual risk

Risk remaining after the checks or controls performed.

IN USE disclose residual risk

test scope

Behavior and conditions included in the checking effort.

IN USE state the test scope

execution evidence

Record of checks actually run and their results.

IN USE distinguish execution evidence

untested path

Execution route with no relevant test result yet.

IN USE identify an untested path

dependency mapping

Identification of relationships between components and consumers.

IN USE use dependency mapping

functional impact

Effect on what users or systems can do.

IN USE assess functional impact

test objective

Purpose a particular check is meant to serve.

IN USE define the test objective

selection rationale

Reason for choosing particular checks.

IN USE explain the selection rationale

coverage claim

Statement about what the tests have exercised.

IN USE limit the coverage claim

test summary

Concise account of scope, results, and limits.

IN USE write the test summary

follow-up check

Additional test proposed after initial evidence.

IN USE schedule a follow-up check

release recommendation

Evidence-based advice about proceeding with a release.

IN USE qualify a release recommendation

Precision check

One hour limits the work, not the meaning of full coverage. Propose focused checks of the changed formatter through both consumer paths, then report what actually ran and any remaining gaps without implying all risks were removed.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

STATE THE NARROW SUCCESS

"Sign-in and opening the account page passed."

IDENTIFY BOTH CONSUMERS

"Account-save and export use that formatter."

CHALLENGE THE LABEL

"An account update can still affect export."

NAME THE TIME LIMIT

"We have one hour for further checking."

NAME THE CHANGE

"The shared formatter changed."

EXPOSE THE GAP

"Neither consumer path has been tested."

EXPLAIN THE PRIORITY

"I would focus the next checks on the changed component's consumers."

KEEP A PROPOSAL PROVISIONAL

"Those checks are planned, not completed."

Neither

Makes clear that both relevant consumer paths lack results.

Still affect

Challenges an assumption that an existing path is outside the change.

Would focus

Offers a reasoned proposal without fabricating a completed plan.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

REQUEST A CLEAR OBJECTIVE

"Check the formatted result in each consumer path."

PRESERVE THE UNKNOWN

"Export behavior after this change remains unverified."

REPORT UNFINISHED WORK

"Keep any untested path visible."

NAME REMAINING EXPOSURE

"There will still be residual risk."

AVOID CLAIMING TOTAL COVERAGE

"A smoke pass is not full regression coverage."

REPORT ACTUAL EXECUTION

"List which checks ran and their results."

SEPARATE EVIDENCE AND ADVICE

"The summary can support a recommendation without proving every risk absent."

CLOSE WITH A BOUNDED PLAN

"Prioritize both affected paths and report the limits of the hour's work."

After this change

Ties the needed evidence to the modified version.

Not full

Limits the coverage meaning of a smoke pass.

Which ... and their

Requires named checks paired with actual outcomes.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which summary is accurate?

- A** The formatter is fully verified
- B** Smoke passed for sign-in and page opening; save and export remain untested
- C** All account behavior passed
- D** Export is unaffected because it is old

2. Why include export in follow-up?

- A** Every old feature must be rewritten
- B** The smoke test already failed export
- C** Export is the only account feature
- D** It uses the changed formatter

3. What does one hour justify?

- A** Ignoring all shared consumers
- B** Prioritized checks with disclosed gaps
- C** A full-coverage claim without execution
- D** Automatic release approval

4. Which statement confuses plan and evidence?

- A** Both paths passed because we intend to check them
- B** Both paths need checking
- C** The current smoke scope is narrow
- D** One hour remains for further work

Answers and explanations: [page 82](#).

The account page opens; the changed paths are unchecked

E Conversations / turns 1-10

04

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

smoke test / selection rationale / execution evidence / change impact / test objective / test summary / timebox / coverage gap / residual risk / shared component

- 01 **Elena:** The smoke test passed for sign-in and opening the account page. I want to keep that wording narrow because we have not checked account-save or export.
- 02 **Sam:** Agreed. A ¹ _____ result is useful, but its scope matters. What changed that makes those two paths the next candidates for checking?
- 03 **Elena:** The formatter changed, and both paths use it. Although the update is described as an account change, the existing export path consumes the same component.
- 04 **Sam:** Then the ² _____ connects the risks. We should not exclude export just because it was already present before this update.
- 05 **Elena:** Exactly. Opening the account page does not tell us whether saving an account produces the correct formatted result. It also says nothing about the exported output.
- 06 **Sam:** That is a clear ³ _____. We have evidence for two basic actions, but not for the consumer behavior most directly linked to the change.
- 07 **Elena:** With one hour available, I propose focused checks through both consumers. I would make the expected formatted output explicit in each case.
- 08 **Sam:** That gives a ⁴ _____ tied to the modification rather than simply adding unrelated checks until the hour is gone.
- 09 **Elena:** I cannot promise full regression coverage in that time. The handoff should name what we manage to run and what remains unchecked.
- 10 **Sam:** Yes. The ⁵ _____ limits the amount of checking; it does not make a small set equivalent to full coverage.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 37.

- 11 **Elena:** Would it be fair to say export is high priority because it shares the formatter, without inventing a probability that it will fail?
- 12 **Sam:** Explain the ⁶ _____ relationship directly. We do not need a made-up percentage to justify checking a path that uses the changed code.
- 13 **Elena:** I will also avoid marking the proposed checks passed in the status table before execution. At the moment, both paths remain untested.
- 14 **Sam:** Keep ⁷ _____ separate from the plan. Planned, running, passed, and failed are different statuses, even when the next steps look straightforward.
- 15 **Elena:** If the hour ends before every intended check finishes, I will carry those items forward as gaps. I will not silently drop them from the summary.
- 16 **Sam:** That makes ⁸ _____ visible. A useful report shows the remaining exposure alongside the new evidence rather than presenting a clean-looking but incomplete table.
- 17 **Elena:** The account-save check and export check should each have an expected result tied to the formatter. Merely reaching the screen would repeat the smoke-test limitation.
- 18 **Sam:** Right. State the ⁹ _____ so the action and assertion address the change. Otherwise we could increase the test count without answering the relevant question.
- 19 **Elena:** My update will say smoke passed for sign-in and page opening, both formatter consumers untested, one hour available, and focused follow-up proposed.
- 20 **Sam:** That is an accurate ¹⁰ _____. We can use the subsequent results to inform a recommendation while keeping any unfinished work and release decision separate.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 83

1. smoke test | 2. shared component | 3. coverage gap | 4. selection rationale | 5. timebox | 6. change impact | 7. execution evidence | 8. residual risk | 9. test objective | 10. test summary

Keep scope, change, and time together

F Say it

Complete the testing update before the proposed follow-up checks have run.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

tested / formatter / hour / smoke

Tester: "The ¹ _____ test covered sign-in and opening the page."

Lead: "Both paths use the changed ² _____."

Tester: "Neither account-save nor export has been ³ _____."

Lead: "We have one ⁴ _____ for further checking."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 83

1. smoke | 2. formatter | 3. tested | 4. hour

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Cleanup deletes what search expects

A Read the situation

Describe an order-dependent automated failure and request isolated test data instead of treating reruns as a fix.

On fictional build T8, an automated search check fails when it follows a cleanup check but passes when run alone. The cleanup removes a shared sample record that search expects. No code change occurs between these observations. Automation engineer Noah and tester Aisha compare the starting state and execution order. They need to remove the shared-data interference and verify the revised arrangement rather than simply rerun until the suite appears green.

PEOPLE / Noah: Automation engineer | Aisha: Tester

INCONSISTENT DOES NOT MEAN MEANINGLESS

Different outcomes can become understandable when hidden conditions are named. Record order and data state before calling a test random. A passing rerun can be evidence about changed conditions, but it does not erase the earlier failure or repair isolation.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. When does the search check fail?

- A On every build
- B After the cleanup check
- C Whenever run alone
- D Only after a code change

2. What does cleanup remove?

- A The T8 build
- B A confirmed unrelated log only
- C The shared sample record search expects
- D All test source code

3. What changes between the observations?

- A Every environment setting
- B Order and relevant starting state, not code
- C The code is confirmed rewritten
- D The search requirement disappears

Answers and explanations: [page 84](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

flaky test

Test showing inconsistent outcomes under apparently similar conditions.

IN USE investigate a flaky test

order dependency

Dependence of a result on the sequence of test execution.

IN USE expose an order dependency

shared fixture

Prepared data or state used by multiple checks.

IN USE isolate a shared fixture

setup

Preparation establishing a test's starting conditions.

IN USE verify setup

teardown

Work restoring or removing state after a test.

IN USE review teardown

cleanup

Removal of data or resources no longer needed by a check.

IN USE limit cleanup scope

test isolation

Independence of a test from other tests' state changes.

IN USE restore test isolation

state leakage

Unintended influence of one test's state on another.

IN USE detect state leakage

sample record

Prepared data item used for testing.

IN USE preserve the sample record

precondition

Required state before a check starts.

IN USE establish the precondition

execution order

Sequence in which checks run.

IN USE record execution order

standalone run

Execution of a check without the surrounding suite.

IN USE compare a standalone run

Precision check

The search result differs with test order because cleanup removes its expected sample record. No code change is needed for this interference to matter. Compare the starting state, not just the build identifier.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

suite run

Execution of a group of related checks.

IN USE inspect the suite run

rerun

Another execution of an existing check.

IN USE qualify a rerun result

false alarm

Failure signal not caused by the claimed product defect.

IN USE investigate a false alarm

failure evidence

Records supporting an observed unsuccessful result.

IN USE retain failure evidence

test data ownership

Responsibility for creating and removing test records.

IN USE define test data ownership

unique test data

Data assigned specifically to one test or execution.

IN USE use unique test data

deterministic setup

Preparation that establishes predictable required conditions.

IN USE create deterministic setup

environment state

Relevant current conditions in the test setting.

IN USE compare environment state

interference

Effect of one check on another's operation.

IN USE remove test interference

quarantine

Temporary separation of an unreliable check under a defined policy.

IN USE review quarantine status

continuous integration

Frequent integration with automated checking; abbreviated CI.

IN USE investigate the CI result

verification run

Execution used to check whether a proposed correction works.

IN USE perform a verification run

Precision check

A passing standalone rerun is not a repair of the suite. Define data ownership and setup so each check has its required state without deleting another check's data, then verify both the relevant sequence and isolated behavior.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

IDENTIFY THE BUILD

"Both observations are on T8."

REPORT THE COMPARISON

"Search passes when run alone."

NAME THE SHARED DEPENDENCY

"Both checks depend on the sample record's state."

AVOID CALLING IT RANDOM

"The observed pattern is order-dependent."

REPORT THE FAILING ORDER

"Search fails after cleanup."

PRESERVE THE CODE FACT

"No code changed between those observations."

EXPLAIN CLEANUP'S EFFECT

"Cleanup removes the record search expects."

REQUEST THE STARTING STATE

"Was the required record present when search began?"

After

Makes sequence part of the reported condition.

When run alone

Identifies the comparison as a different execution context.

No code changed

Removes one explanation without claiming all conditions were identical.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

SEPARATE RERUN AND REPAIR

"A passing rerun does not fix isolation."

PROPOSE ISOLATION

"Give the checks independent data or a defined setup."

AVOID SUPPRESSING THE SYMPTOM

"Do not remove the assertion merely to get green."

LIMIT THE CONCLUSION

"The standalone pass does not prove the suite is reliable."

REQUEST OWNERSHIP

"Which check creates and removes this record?"

PRESERVE THE EVIDENCE

"Keep the failed sequence and logs."

REQUEST VERIFICATION

"Check the revised arrangement in the relevant sequence."

CLOSE WITH THE CAUSE OF INTERFERENCE

"Resolve shared-data ownership and verify the resulting behavior."

Required record

Names a specific precondition rather than vague environment trouble.

Does not fix

Distinguishes another observation from an actual correction.

Relevant sequence

Requests verification where the interference was originally observed.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which explanation matches the evidence?

- A** The code changes between every run
- B** Search never passes
- C** Every failure is random
- D** Cleanup removes data needed by the later search check

2. What should be compared?

- A** Only the color of the test report
- B** Unrelated production traffic
- C** A made-up build number
- D** Execution order and starting data state

3. Which action is not a demonstrated fix?

- A** Verify required setup
- B** Rerun alone until the check passes
- C** Define independent test data
- D** Review cleanup scope

4. What should verification include?

- A** The relevant sequence after the data arrangement is corrected
- B** Only deleting the failing assertion
- C** A claim that no tests need data
- D** An unchanged summary saying always passes

Answers and explanations: [page 84](#).

Cleanup deletes what search expects

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

05

WORD + PHRASE BANK

failure evidence / test data ownership / order dependency / environment state / test isolation / rerun / execution order / verification run / interference / precondition

- 01 **Noah:** The search check is inconsistent on T8. It fails after cleanup but passes on its own, and there was no code change between those observations.
- 02 **Aisha:** Let us record the ¹ _____ before calling it random. What does cleanup change that the standalone search run might still have available?
- 03 **Noah:** Cleanup removes the shared sample record. Search expects that record to be present, so its starting state is different after cleanup has run.
- 04 **Aisha:** That is an ² _____. The build can stay identical while the data changes enough to alter the result.
- 05 **Noah:** I was going to add automatic reruns because the isolated attempt is green. That would make the report look better without repairing the shared-data problem.
- 06 **Aisha:** Exactly. A ³ _____ gives another observation. It is not a correction unless the underlying conditions have actually been made reliable and the relevant behavior verified.
- 07 **Noah:** We should document which check owns the record. At present, one check removes something another assumes will remain available.
- 08 **Aisha:** Define ⁴ _____ explicitly. Otherwise the same interference can return even if a particular sequence happens to pass today.
- 09 **Noah:** One possible revision is independent data for each check. Another is setup that reliably establishes what search requires without relying on a previous check.
- 10 **Aisha:** Both address ⁵ _____, but the chosen arrangement still needs review and execution. A design proposal is not yet proof that the suite behaves reliably.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 46.

- 11 **Noah:** I will preserve the failed sequence in the issue. The standalone pass should be included too, with its different context rather than as a replacement.
- 12 **Aisha:** Good. Keep the ⁶ _____. Deleting the earlier result would hide the condition that made the dependency visible.
- 13 **Noah:** The check's required record is really a precondition. It should not be an undocumented assumption about whatever data the environment happens to contain.
- 14 **Aisha:** Yes. A ⁷ _____ should be established and visible. Then a missing fixture can be distinguished from the product behavior the assertion is intended to examine.
- 15 **Noah:** We also need to review cleanup's scope. It should not remove records belonging to another check merely because they share a broad label.
- 16 **Aisha:** That is the ⁸ _____ we are addressing. Preserve the search assertion and change the data arrangement rather than weakening the check just to get a green result.
- 17 **Noah:** After the revision, I want to run the relevant sequence and the isolated search case. We should compare actual results, not assume separation solved everything.
- 18 **Aisha:** A ⁹ _____ should target the original condition. Record setup, order, and result so the conclusion is tied to what was exercised.
- 19 **Noah:** My summary will say T8, no code change, failure after cleanup, standalone pass, and shared sample deletion. The data isolation correction remains to be verified.
- 20 **Aisha:** That describes the ¹⁰ _____ precisely. We can investigate a concrete dependency instead of treating inconsistent results as permission to ignore the test.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 85

1. execution order | 2. order dependency | 3. rerun | 4. test data ownership | 5. test isolation | 6. failure evidence | 7. precondition | 8. interference | 9. verification run | 10. environment state

Name the hidden difference

F Say it

Complete the automation report using the observed order and shared-record facts.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

cleanup / record / isolation / T8

Engineer: "Both observations use build ¹ _____."

Tester: "Search fails after ² _____."

Engineer: "The shared sample ³ _____ is removed."

Tester: "A standalone pass does not prove test ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 85

1. T8 | 2. cleanup | 3. record | 4. isolation

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

The missing export row and tomorrow's visible typo

A Read the situation

Compare functional impact, reach, and timing without equating demonstration urgency with defect severity or release approval.

06

An export defect omits the final row in one monthly workflow. A heading typo appears on every account page. Tomorrow's customer demonstration uses the account page, with no export planned. Tester Lina and product lead Marcus discuss triage. The export has a data-completeness impact; the typo has broad visibility and immediate demonstration relevance. No severity scale, final repair order, or approval to release either issue is supplied.

PEOPLE / Lina: Tester | Marcus: Product lead

KEEP TWO DIMENSIONS ON THE TABLE

Teams can disagree because one person is discussing harm and another is discussing timing. Name each dimension before comparing issues. A visible typo may be urgent for an event without making lost export data harmless, and discussing either issue does not authorize release.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What does the export defect do?

- | | |
|--|--|
| A Prevents all sign-ins | B Deletes every database record |
| C Omits the final row in one monthly workflow | D Misspells every account heading |

2. What will tomorrow's demonstration use?

- | | |
|---|----------------------------------|
| A The account page, with no export planned | B Only the monthly export |
| C Every workflow | D Neither affected area |

3. What decision has already been made?

- | | |
|--|--|
| A No final repair order or release approval is supplied | B The typo must always be first |
| C The export is approved for release | D Both defects are waived |

Answers and explanations: page 86.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

triage

Structured review to classify issues and decide next handling.

IN USE bring a defect to triage

severity

Degree of impact caused by a defect under the relevant scale.

IN USE assess severity

priority

Relative urgency or order assigned to work.

IN USE set priority

functional impact

Effect on the ability to perform the intended task.

IN USE explain functional impact

visibility

Extent to which users encounter or notice an issue.

IN USE describe visibility

reach

Range of users or surfaces affected.

IN USE distinguish reach from harm

frequency

How often the relevant event or workflow occurs.

IN USE state workflow frequency

data completeness

Presence of all required data items.

IN USE verify data completeness

cosmetic defect

Presentation issue without an established functional failure here.

IN USE classify a cosmetic defect carefully

customer demonstration

Planned presentation of product behavior to a customer.

IN USE prepare for the customer demonstration

business timing

Importance arising from an event or deadline.

IN USE explain business timing

repair order

Sequence in which issues are scheduled for correction.

IN USE agree the repair order

Precision check

Monthly describes when the export workflow occurs; it does not make a missing row trivial. Every account page describes the type's reach; it does not make its functional impact identical to missing export data.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

release blocker

Issue preventing release under the applicable criteria.

IN USE identify a release blocker

waiver

Explicit authorized acceptance of an exception.

IN USE record a waiver

risk acceptance

Authorized decision to proceed with identified exposure.

IN USE distinguish risk acceptance

workaround

Alternative way to complete a task despite a defect.

IN USE verify a workaround

affected workflow

Process in which the reported issue occurs.

IN USE name the affected workflow

stakeholder impact

Consequence for people who rely on the product.

IN USE assess stakeholder impact

defect classification

Assignment of an issue to a defined category.

IN USE explain defect classification

scheduling constraint

Limit affecting when work can be performed.

IN USE state the scheduling constraint

decision owner

Person responsible for a specified decision.

IN USE identify the decision owner

evidence-based comparison

Comparison grounded in observed effects and stated context.

IN USE make an evidence-based comparison

defer

Postpone work without claiming the issue is resolved.

IN USE document a decision to defer

disposition

Recorded decision about how an issue will be handled.

IN USE record the disposition

Precision check

Tomorrow's demonstration creates a timing reason to discuss the typo urgently. It does not automatically set a universal severity ranking, decide the repair order, or approve release with either defect. Those decisions require the actual process and authority.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

NAME THE EXPORT EFFECT

"The export omits its final row."

NAME THE TYPO'S REACH

"The heading typo appears on every account page."

PRESERVE THE EXCLUSION

"No export is planned for the demonstration."

AVOID MINIMIZING

"Monthly use does not make missing data harmless."

LIMIT THE AFFECTED WORKFLOW

"The observed issue affects the monthly workflow."

STATE TOMORROW'S SCOPE

"The demonstration uses the account page."

SEPARATE DIMENSIONS

"Impact and scheduling urgency are different questions."

AVOID INFLATING

"Broad visibility does not automatically mean greater functional harm."

06

Affects

Names the observed consequence without inventing additional damage.

Does not make

Rejects an invalid inference from frequency or reach.

Immediately relevant

Expresses timing without assigning a severity category.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

EXPLAIN TIMING

"The demonstration makes the typo immediately relevant."

KEEP THE DECISION OPEN

"We have not agreed the repair order."

REQUEST A RECORDED DECISION

"Please record the disposition for each issue."

PRESERVE BOTH CONCERNS

"Keep data completeness and presentation visibility in the comparison."

REQUEST THE SCALE

"Which severity definitions apply here?"

AVOID IMPLYING PERMISSION

"Triage discussion is not release approval."

AVOID INVENTING A WORKAROUND

"We have not established an alternative export method."

CLOSE WITH THE DISTINCTION

"Discuss impact, timing, and authorization separately."

06

Which definitions

Requests the actual scale instead of assuming a universal one.

Have not agreed

Keeps scheduling unresolved.

For each issue

Prevents one broad statement from concealing different dispositions.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

06

1. Which comparison is accurate?

- A** Export loses a row; the typo is widely visible and relevant to tomorrow's demo
- B** The monthly defect is harmless
- C** The typo destroys all account data
- D** Neither issue has any user effect

2. What does the demonstration establish?

- A** Proof export is correct
- B** A timing reason to discuss the typo urgently
- C** Automatic permission to release both defects
- D** A universal severity ranking

3. Which claim needs more evidence?

- A** No export is planned for the demo
- B** A workaround exists for the export
- C** The export omits its final row
- D** The typo appears on every account page

4. Which statement avoids a false decision?

- A** The typo is automatically first under every policy
- B** The export has been waived
- C** Both issues are approved for release
- D** The repair order and release disposition still need agreement

Answers and explanations: [page 86](#).

The missing export row and tomorrow's visible typo

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

06

WORD + PHRASE BANK

business timing / workaround / risk acceptance / Reach / evidence-based comparison / defect classification / functional impact / Priority / Frequency / disposition

- 01 **Lina:** We have two issues for triage: the monthly export omits its final row, and a heading typo appears on every account page. I want to compare them without mixing impact and timing.
- 02 **Marcus:** Start with the ¹ _____ of the export. A missing row affects the completeness of that workflow's output, even though the workflow runs monthly.
- 03 **Lina:** Right. Monthly tells us how often the workflow is used, not that its data is unimportant. We should not reduce the description to a rare cosmetic problem.
- 04 **Marcus:** Agreed. ² _____ is one part of the context, not a substitute for describing the effect. What is established about the typo?
- 05 **Lina:** It is visible on every account page. Tomorrow's customer demonstration uses that page, and no export is planned for the demonstration.
- 06 **Marcus:** That gives the typo immediate ³ _____. We should discuss it urgently for that reason, while keeping its presentation effect distinct from the export's missing data.
- 07 **Lina:** Could we say the typo has greater reach in the observed interface, but avoid claiming that broader visibility automatically makes it more severe?
- 08 **Marcus:** Yes. ⁴ _____ and severity are not synonyms. A widespread heading error and an incomplete export have different consequences that need separate descriptions.
- 09 **Lina:** We also do not have a severity scale in front of us. I would rather use the observed effects than invent critical or minor labels.
- 10 **Marcus:** Use the applicable ⁵ _____ process when those labels are assigned. For this discussion, the concrete effects and timing are enough to explain the competing concerns.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 55.

- 11 **Lina:** Does focusing on the typo for tomorrow mean the export is approved for release? I want to avoid that implication in the meeting notes.
- 12 **Marcus:** No. ⁶ _____ concerns what receives attention and when. It is not permission to ship a known issue, and we have not finalized the repair order either.
- 13 **Lina:** Then each issue needs its own recorded disposition. A general note saying handled would not show whether it was fixed, deferred, or still awaiting a decision.
- 14 **Marcus:** Exactly. Record the ⁷ _____ once the authorized decision is made. Do not write deferred as though it meant corrected.
- 15 **Lina:** We have not established a workaround for the export. I should not suggest users can recover the missing row through another route unless that route is verified.
- 16 **Marcus:** Correct. A ⁸ _____ is another factual claim requiring evidence. It cannot be added just to make the risk summary sound more reassuring.
- 17 **Lina:** My comparison will retain export data completeness, the typo's account-page visibility, tomorrow's demonstration, and the absence of export from that demonstration.
- 18 **Marcus:** That is an ⁹ _____. It gives the team a clear basis for scheduling discussion without pretending a decision has already been reached.
- 19 **Lina:** I will finish with repair order and release disposition pending. That leaves the next decision visible instead of choosing a winner in the report.
- 20 **Marcus:** Good. Keep any ¹⁰ _____ separate and explicit. We can discuss urgency strongly without silently approving either defect for release.

06

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 87

1. functional impact | 2. Frequency | 3. business timing | 4. Reach | 5. defect classification | 6. Priority | 7. disposition | 8. workaround | 9. evidence-based comparison | 10. risk acceptance

Impact is not the same as tomorrow's priority

F Say it

Complete the triage summary without assigning an unsupported rating or release decision.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

06

WORD + PHRASE BANK

row / tomorrow / undecided / page

Tester: "The export omits the final ¹ _____."

Lead: "The typo appears on every account ² _____."

Tester: "The demonstration is ³ _____."

Lead: "The final repair order is still ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 87

1. row | 2. page | 3. tomorrow | 4. undecided

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Saved edits persist; unsaved edits disappear silently

A Read the situation

Report a timeboxed exploratory observation while separating behavior, an unresolved warning requirement, and untested mobile scope.

Tester Isha completes a twenty-minute exploratory session with the charter Investigate interrupted profile edits. Navigating away after a saved edit preserves the value. Navigating away during an unsaved edit loses it without warning. Whether a warning is required is unspecified. Mobile behavior was not explored. Isha debriefs with product analyst Owen, who needs a factual record and a clarification request rather than a claim that every profile edit is broken.

PEOPLE / Isha: Exploratory tester | Owen: Product analyst

07

AN OBSERVATION CAN BE IMPORTANT BEFORE CLASSIFICATION

Describe the exact sequence and what happened, then ask whether the intended behavior requires a warning. This preserves a potentially important user experience without inventing a requirement. Naming untested scope helps colleagues use the finding appropriately.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What was the session's charter?

- A Investigate interrupted profile edits
- C Approve the release

- B Verify every mobile workflow
- D Measure all search latency

2. What happens after a saved edit?

- A The application crashes
- C Every value is lost

- B Navigating away preserves the value
- D A warning always appears

3. What is unresolved?

- A Whether mobile was fully tested
- C Whether the saved value persisted

- B Whether the session lasted twenty minutes
- D Whether a warning is required for unsaved edits

Answers and explanations: [page 88](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

exploratory testing

Investigation that adapts checks as the tester learns.

IN USE conduct exploratory testing

test charter

Statement guiding the purpose of an exploratory session.

IN USE define the test charter

session

Bounded period of testing work.

IN USE document the session

timebox

Fixed time allocated to an investigation.

IN USE respect the timebox

debrief

Discussion reviewing observations, limits, and follow-up.

IN USE hold a debrief

session notes

Record of actions, observations, and questions from testing.

IN USE preserve session notes

observation

Behavior directly seen during the investigation.

IN USE separate observation from interpretation

finding

Recorded result or question arising from investigation.

IN USE report a finding

saved state

Data retained after a completed save under the observed behavior.

IN USE verify saved state

unsaved change

Edit not yet committed by the relevant save action.

IN USE identify an unsaved change

navigation away

Leaving the current view or page.

IN USE describe navigation away

persistence

Continued retention of data across the relevant transition.

IN USE check persistence

Precision check

The saved and unsaved paths have different observations. Saved edits persist after navigation; unsaved edits are lost without warning. Do not merge them into all edits are lost or assume that loss of an unsaved change violates an unstated rule.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

warning prompt

Message alerting a user before a consequential action.

IN USE clarify the warning prompt

state transition

Change from one defined condition to another.

IN USE record the state transition

user journey

Sequence of actions a user takes toward an objective.

IN USE describe the user journey

interruption

Event that breaks or diverts the current workflow.

IN USE investigate an interruption

requirement gap

Missing specification needed to judge intended behavior.

IN USE raise the requirement gap

usability concern

Potential difficulty in understanding or using the product.

IN USE record a usability concern

confirmed defect

Established departure from an applicable expectation.

IN USE distinguish a confirmed defect

follow-up question

Specific unresolved point for further investigation or clarification.

IN USE record a follow-up question

scope exclusion

Area explicitly not covered by the investigation.

IN USE list a scope exclusion

mobile coverage

Evidence from checking behavior on mobile devices or conditions.

IN USE avoid assuming mobile coverage

evidence trail

Records linking a finding to actions and observations.

IN USE retain the evidence trail

session outcome

Bounded summary of findings and remaining questions.

IN USE summarize the session outcome

Precision check

Record the no-warning behavior and request a decision on whether a warning is required. Mobile was not explored, and twenty minutes is the session duration, not evidence of complete profile-edit coverage.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

NAME THE CHARTER

"The session investigated interrupted profile edits."

STATE THE TIMEBOX

"I explored for twenty minutes."

SEPARATE THE SAVED PATH

"After saving, navigation preserved the value."

SEPARATE THE UNSAVED PATH

"Navigating away during an unsaved edit lost the change."

DESCRIBE THE INTERFACE

"No warning appeared in that sequence."

AVOID A BROAD DEFECT CLAIM

"I did not observe all profile edits failing."

EXPOSE THE REQUIREMENT GAP

"The warning requirement is unspecified."

REQUEST THE INTENDED BEHAVIOR

"Should leaving an unsaved edit trigger a warning?"

After versus during

Distinguishes navigation following save from navigation during an unsaved edit.

No warning appeared

Reports an observation without asserting an unstated requirement.

Should ... trigger

Requests the intended behavior as an explicit decision.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

KEEP THE OBSERVATION

"The no-warning behavior remains a useful finding."

STATE THE EXCLUDED SCOPE

"I did not explore mobile behavior."

SEPARATE CLASSIFICATION

"The observation is not yet a confirmed requirement violation."

LIMIT THE CONCLUSION

"These findings apply to the paths explored."

AVOID INVENTING POLICY

"I have not assumed that every unsaved edit must persist."

REQUEST TRACEABLE FOLLOW-UP

"Link the warning decision to the session notes."

PRESERVE THE SEQUENCE

"Record whether save occurred before navigation."

CLOSE THE DEBRIEF

"Saved value persists; unsaved change is lost without warning; requirement and mobile questions remain."

Not yet confirmed

Preserves a finding while qualifying its classification.

Did not explore

Names an evidence gap without predicting the result.

Whether save occurred

Identifies the state distinction needed to reproduce the observation.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which report matches the observations?

- A** Every saved edit is lost
- B** Unsaved edits always persist
- C** Mobile behavior is confirmed identical
- D** Saved edits persist; unsaved edits are lost without warning

2. What should be requested?

- A** A declaration that all edits are broken
- B** Removal of the saved-path observation
- C** Clarification of whether an unsaved-edit warning is required
- D** Automatic release approval

3. Which claim exceeds the evidence?

- A** No warning appeared in the explored unsaved path
- B** The session lasted twenty minutes
- C** Saved value persisted in the explored saved path
- D** Mobile shows the same result

4. Why avoid calling this a confirmed warning defect now?

- A** Unsaved changes cannot affect users
- B** Twenty minutes invalidates every finding
- C** The applicable warning requirement is unspecified
- D** Observations never matter

Answers and explanations: [page 88](#).

Saved edits persist; unsaved edits disappear silently

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

requirement gap / scope exclusion / usability concern / saved state / session outcome / evidence trail / timebox / observation / test charter / confirmed defect

07

- 01 **Isha:** My twenty-minute session focused on interrupted profile edits. I have two different navigation observations and one requirement question, rather than a general claim that editing is broken.
- 02 **Owen:** Start with the ¹ _____. That will help me understand which paths you explored and what the session was not intended to settle.
- 03 **Isha:** The charter was to investigate interrupted profile edits. When I saved an edit and then navigated away, the value remained present.
- 04 **Owen:** So the ² _____ persisted in that sequence. Keep it separate from what happened when navigation occurred before the edit was saved.
- 05 **Isha:** In the unsaved sequence, I navigated away while the edit was still unsaved. The change was lost, and no warning appeared before leaving.
- 06 **Owen:** That is a specific ³ _____. We can record both the lost change and the absence of a warning without yet deciding whether either violates a requirement.
- 07 **Isha:** The requirement does not say whether a warning is needed. I did not want to choose the product policy myself and then judge the application against it.
- 08 **Owen:** Raise that ⁴ _____ explicitly. Ask whether leaving an unsaved edit should trigger a warning, rather than treating your preferred behavior as already agreed.
- 09 **Isha:** I will keep the actual sequence in the notes: edit without saving, navigate away, change absent, no warning. That should make the question concrete.
- 10 **Owen:** The ⁵ _____ matters. A note saying profile loses data would omit the saved-versus-unsaved distinction and could misrepresent the finding.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 64.

- 11 **Isha:** There is a usability concern even before classification, because someone may leave without realizing the change will disappear. But that is not the same as a confirmed requirement violation.
- 12 **Owen:** Correct. A ⁶ _____ can be worth discussing while its status remains clear. We do not need to exaggerate the evidence to make the question relevant.
- 13 **Isha:** I did not explore mobile behavior. I want that exclusion visible so the report is not copied into a broader statement about every platform.
- 14 **Owen:** List the ⁷ _____. Untested mobile behavior is unknown, not assumed identical and not assumed different.
- 15 **Isha:** The twenty-minute limit also matters. I explored these paths, but the duration does not mean every possible interruption was covered.
- 16 **Owen:** Exactly. The ⁸ _____ explains the session boundary. Report the actual paths and questions rather than using elapsed time as a proxy for exhaustive checking.
- 17 **Isha:** Once the owner clarifies the warning rule, the relevant case can be checked against that expectation. Until then, the observation should remain attached to the question.
- 18 **Owen:** That keeps ⁹ _____ separate from an unresolved finding. The eventual decision may change the classification without changing what you actually observed.
- 19 **Isha:** My debrief summary will preserve the saved-path success, the unsaved loss without warning, the missing warning requirement, and the absence of mobile exploration.
- 20 **Owen:** Good. That is a bounded ¹⁰ _____. It gives the next reviewer concrete evidence and one answerable follow-up question, rather than a broad label they have to reconstruct.

07

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 89

1. test charter | 2. saved state | 3. observation | 4. requirement gap | 5. evidence trail | 6. usability concern | 7. scope exclusion | 8. timebox | 9. confirmed defect | 10. session outcome

Separate the two paths and the missing rule

F Say it

Complete the exploratory report without converting an observation into an unsupported requirement judgment.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

07

WORD + PHRASE BANK

saved / minutes / warning / Mobile

Tester: "The session lasted twenty ¹ _____."

Analyst: "The ² _____ edit persisted after navigation."

Tester: "The unsaved edit was lost without a ³ _____."

Analyst: "⁴ _____ behavior was not explored."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 89

1. minutes | 2. saved | 3. warning | 4. Mobile

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Seven passed is not ten completed

A Read the situation

Report pass, failure, and blocked counts while identifying the unmet critical-path criterion and preserving release ownership.

Fictional candidate Q20 has ten planned checks. Seven passed, one failed, and two are blocked by unavailable sample data. One blocked check is critical. The agreed exit criterion requires every critical-path check to be executed and reviewed. Tester Ben hands the evidence to release owner Mara. The critical blocked check means this criterion is not met. Mara has not made the release decision; the test summary is not approval.

08

PEOPLE / Ben: Tester preparing the handover | Mara: Release decision owner

DO NOT LET A PERCENTAGE HIDE A BLOCKER

A headline pass count can sound reassuring while omitting an unexecuted critical path. Give the complete breakdown, explain the relevant criterion, and name the missing evidence. Keep your report of readiness conditions separate from the authorized release decision.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. How are the ten checks divided?

- A** Seven passed and three passed by assumption
- B** Eight passed and two failed
- C** Ten executed and reviewed
- D** Seven passed, one failed, two blocked

2. Why is the critical-path criterion unmet?

- A** All seven passes are invalid
- B** Every blocked check has failed
- C** No criterion exists
- D** One critical check is blocked and unexecuted

3. Who owns the release decision?

- A** The pass percentage
- B** Every user
- C** The unavailable sample data
- D** Mara

Answers and explanations: page 90.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

release candidate

Version proposed for release pending the relevant decision.

IN USE identify the release candidate

planned check

Test included in the intended checking scope.

IN USE count planned checks

passed check

Executed check meeting its expected result.

IN USE report passed checks

failed check

Executed check not meeting its expected result.

IN USE report the failed check

blocked check

Check unable to proceed because a prerequisite is unavailable.

IN USE identify blocked checks

sample data

Prepared input needed to execute a test.

IN USE obtain sample data

critical path

Essential workflow or route under the agreed release criteria here.

IN USE identify the critical path

exit criterion

Condition required before leaving a testing stage.

IN USE assess the exit criterion

execution status

Whether and how a test has been run.

IN USE distinguish execution status

review status

Whether relevant evidence has received the required review.

IN USE report review status

test completion

End-of-stage accounting of performed work and unresolved items.

IN USE assess test completion

pass rate

Proportion of passes under a stated denominator.

IN USE qualify the pass rate

08

Precision check

Seven plus one plus two accounts for all ten planned checks. Eight have executed; two have not. Seven out of ten planned is 70 percent, while seven out of eight executed is 87.5 percent. Neither percentage makes the critical blocked check disappear.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

denominator

Total used to calculate a fraction or percentage.

IN USE specify the denominator

blocked dependency

Missing prerequisite preventing a check from proceeding.

IN USE resolve the blocked dependency

open defect

Unresolved product issue recorded for follow-up.

IN USE retain the open defect

readiness evidence

Results and records relevant to whether criteria are satisfied.

IN USE present readiness evidence

release authority

Permission or role empowered to decide release.

IN USE respect release authority

decision pending

Status showing that a decision has not been made.

IN USE keep decision pending

status breakdown

Separate counts or categories explaining the overall position.

IN USE give the status breakdown

evidence handover

Transfer of results, limits, and unresolved dependencies.

IN USE prepare the evidence handover

criterion exception

Explicit authorized departure from an agreed criterion.

IN USE document a criterion exception

risk register

Record of identified risks and their handling.

IN USE update the risk register

unexecuted check

Planned check that has not actually run.

IN USE disclose the unexecuted check

release disposition

Recorded decision on whether and how to proceed.

IN USE record the release disposition

Precision check

The agreed criterion is unmet because a critical check has not executed and therefore cannot have its result reviewed. A summary must say this directly. No exception or release approval has been granted, and Mara retains the pending decision.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

IDENTIFY THE CANDIDATE

"This handover concerns Q20."

GIVE PASSES

"Seven checks passed."

GIVE BLOCKERS

"Two checks are blocked by unavailable sample data."

STATE THE CRITERION

"All critical-path checks must be executed and reviewed."

STATE THE TOTAL

"Ten checks were planned."

GIVE FAILURES

"One check failed."

IDENTIFY THE CRITICAL GAP

"One blocked check is critical."

STATE THE CONSEQUENCE

"That criterion is not currently met."

08

Planned versus executed

Distinguishes ten intended checks from the eight that actually ran.

Currently

States the present criterion status without predicting the final decision.

By unavailable data

Names the dependency causing the blocked status.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

SEPARATE BLOCKED AND FAILED

"Blocked does not mean executed and failed."

QUALIFY THE PERCENTAGE

"Name whether the denominator is planned or executed checks."

REQUEST THE DEPENDENCY

"The blocked checks need their sample data."

AVOID IMPLYING APPROVAL

"The decision remains pending."

SEPARATE BLOCKED AND PASSED

"Missing data cannot count as a pass."

PRESERVE THE FAILURE

"Keep the failed check visible alongside the blockers."

NAME AUTHORITY

"Mara owns the release decision."

CLOSE THE HANDOVER

"Report the full breakdown, unmet criterion, and next evidence needed."

08

Must be ... and

Preserves both execution and review requirements.

Alongside

Keeps failures visible rather than reporting only blockers.

Remains pending

Makes clear that a report is not an authorization.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. How many checks have executed?

- A Seven
- B Two
- C Eight
- D Ten

2. What is seven divided by ten in this report?

- A Passes as a share of planned checks
- B Proof all critical checks passed
- C The share of blocked checks
- D A release approval score

3. Which criterion statement is justified?

- A It does not apply to blocked checks
- B It is automatically waived by missing data
- C It is unmet because a critical check remains unexecuted
- D It is met because most checks passed

4. Which handover is complete?

- A Q20: seven passed, one failed, two blocked including one critical; criterion unmet; Mara's decision pending
- B Q20 passed because seven is a majority
- C Q20 has only two minor gaps
- D Q20 approved automatically

Answers and explanations: page 90.

Seven passed is not ten completed

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

denominator / blocked dependency / blocked check / execution status / Review status / readiness
evidence / failed check / exit criterion / release authority / status breakdown

08

- 01 **Ben:** Here is the Q20 evidence handover. We planned ten checks: seven passed, one failed, and two could not run because the required sample data was unavailable.
- 02 **Mara:** Keep that full ¹ _____ at the top. Which of the blocked checks matters to the agreed critical-path criterion?
- 03 **Ben:** One blocked check is critical. The criterion requires all critical-path checks to be executed and reviewed, so we do not currently meet it.
- 04 **Mara:** Correct. The ² _____ is not satisfied by a majority of passes. We need to state the missing critical evidence directly.
- 05 **Ben:** I will not label that blocked check failed, because it did not execute. But I will not count it as passed simply because no failing result exists.
- 06 **Mara:** Exactly. A ³ _____ has a different status from a completed pass or failure. The absence of a result is the important fact here.
- 07 **Ben:** Eight checks executed in total: the seven passes and the one failure. The other two remain unexecuted, with sample data as their dependency.
- 08 **Mara:** That makes the ⁴ _____ clear. It also prevents someone from reading ten planned as ten completed.
- 09 **Ben:** A percentage could be misleading without the denominator. Seven out of ten planned is seventy percent, while seven out of eight executed is eighty-seven-point-five percent.
- 10 **Mara:** Yes. Specify the ⁵ _____ whenever you report a rate. Neither number changes the fact that an essential path has not been checked.



The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 73.

- 11 **Ben:** The failed check also needs to remain visible. Focusing on the missing data should not make the actual failure disappear from the handover.
- 12 **Mara:** Keep the ⁶ _____ alongside the blockers. They require different follow-up, and a clean-looking pass rate cannot substitute for either explanation.
- 13 **Ben:** The immediate prerequisite for the blocked checks is the unavailable sample data. We need that before execution can produce any result to review.
- 14 **Mara:** Name that ⁷ _____ precisely. Do not turn data requested into data received or assume the later check will pass once the prerequisite arrives.
- 15 **Ben:** I will also retain the review requirement. Executing a critical check would be necessary, but the criterion says its evidence must be reviewed too.
- 16 **Mara:** Good. ⁸ _____ must not be silently inferred from execution. We need both parts of the agreed condition accounted for.
- 17 **Ben:** My report will say the criterion is unmet and your release decision remains pending. I have no recorded exception or permission to proceed.
- 18 **Mara:** That respects ⁹ _____. I own the decision, but I have not made it. Do not phrase this handover as a sign-off from either of us.
- 19 **Ben:** The final line will identify Q20, all ten statuses, the critical blocked check, the missing sample data, and the unresolved decision.
- 20 **Mara:** That is useful ¹⁰ _____. It allows an explicit decision process while keeping the failure, unexecuted critical path, and required review visible.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 91

1. status breakdown | 2. exit criterion | 3. blocked check | 4. execution status | 5. denominator | 6. failed check | 7. blocked dependency | 8. Review status | 9. release authority | 10. readiness evidence

Account for every planned check

F Say it

Complete the Q20 handover. The release decision has not been made.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

Seven / pending / One / Two

08

Tester: "1 _____ checks passed."

Owner: "2 _____ check failed."

Tester: "3 _____ checks are blocked by missing sample data."

Owner: "The release decision remains 4 _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 91

1. Seven | 2. One | 3. Two | 4. pending

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

01 Briefing and language checks

Agreeing the expected result

A Briefing checks / page 4

1. Which case is contradictory?

A. Cancellation exactly 24 hours before the event

The two supplied examples disagree specifically at exactly twenty-four hours.

2. Who can clarify the intended rule?

C. The requirement owner

The scenario gives the requirement owner authority to clarify the equality case.

3. What is outside this discussion?

D. Time-zone handling

Time-zone handling is explicitly excluded from this exercise's scope.

D Language checks / page 9

1. Which question is most precise?

C. At exactly 24 hours before the event, should cancellation be accepted or rejected?

The question identifies the exact input on which the examples conflict.

2. What should serve as the test expectation?

C. The explicitly clarified requirement

A justified expectation must follow the agreed rule rather than an unsupported assumption.

3. Which status is accurate now?

A. Equality remains unresolved

No owner decision has resolved the contradictory equality examples yet.

4. What should follow clarification?

A. Align the examples and link the test to the decision

Updating conflicting examples and preserving the decision supports consistent test expectations.

01 Conversation answers

Agreeing the expected result

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 10-11

- 1. equality case.** Turn 2. Equality case is the input exactly twenty-four hours before the event, where the examples disagree.
- 2. contradiction.** Turn 4. Contradiction identifies the incompatible accept and reject outcomes assigned to the same input.
- 3. assumption.** Turn 6. Assumption marks Maya's preferred interpretation as unconfirmed rather than an agreed cancellation rule.
- 4. scope boundary.** Turn 8. Scope boundary excludes time-zone handling and keeps the discussion focused on the conflicting endpoint rule.
- 5. test oracle.** Turn 10. Test oracle is the reference for correct behavior and cannot be established merely by copying the current implementation.
- 6. decision record.** Turn 12. Decision record preserves the owner's clarified outcome so examples and tests can consistently refer to it.
- 7. inclusive limit.** Turn 14. Inclusive limit would include the endpoint, but that interpretation has not yet been selected for this requirement.
- 8. clarification request.** Turn 16. Clarification request asks for the missing authoritative outcome while retaining the evidence of the conflicting examples.
- 9. traceability.** Turn 18. Traceability links the updated test and examples to the requirement decision that justifies their expectation.
- 10. pass/fail judgment.** Turn 20. Pass/fail judgment requires an agreed expected outcome, which the unresolved equality case does not yet provide.

F Transfer conversation

Page 12

1. 24

Tester: "The examples conflict at exactly 24 hours."

Both examples concern the exact twenty-four-hour boundary before the event.

2. unresolved

Owner: "The equality case remains unresolved."

No decision has selected acceptance or rejection for that exact case.

3. result

Tester: "The test needs an agreed expected result."

A test judgment requires an authoritative expected result for the input.

4. discussion

Owner: "Time-zone handling is outside this discussion."

The scenario explicitly excludes time-zone handling from this focused clarification.

02 Briefing and language checks

Making a failure reproducible

A Briefing checks / page 13

1. Which build did Hana test?

D. Q12

The reported omission was observed specifically on build Q12.

2. What did Joel successfully export?

C. One item

Joel's successful attempt used one item rather than Hana's three-item selection.

3. What frequency is established?

A. Two omissions in two attempts with the saved selection

Hana observed the same omission in both of her two stated attempts.

D Language checks / page 18

1. Which title best preserves the evidence?

A. Q12 export omits last item from saved three-item selection, observed twice

The title includes the build, input, behavior, and bounded observed frequency.

2. Why does Joel's result not refute Hana's?

D. The selection size differs

A one-item input does not reproduce the reported three-item conditions.

3. Which next attempt is most directly relevant?

D. Use Q12 and the same saved three-item selection

Matching the reported build and input directly checks the existing reproduction.

4. Which claim is unsupported?

B. Every selection size is affected

No selection sizes beyond the stated one-item and three-item cases have been checked.

02 Conversation answers

Making a failure reproducible

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 19-20

1. cannot reproduce. Turn 2. Cannot reproduce must be qualified by Joel's different one-item attempt rather than treated as refutation of Hana's conditions.

2. input parity. Turn 4. Input parity requires using the same saved three-item selection instead of comparing it with a different one-item input.

3. actual output. Turn 6. Actual output is the produced export, which demonstrates the specific missing final item rather than a total export failure.

4. denominator. Turn 8. Denominator is the two total attempts supporting the observed two-out-of-two frequency, not an unlimited set of exports.

5. confirmation run. Turn 10. Confirmation run describes the repeated attempt under the reported conditions, while leaving broader behavior untested.

6. defect report. Turn 12. Defect report can document reproducible behavior and conditions without inventing an internal explanation for the omission.

7. build identifier. Turn 14. Build identifier Q12 ties the observation to the tested software version and prevents assumptions about untested builds.

8. scope of evidence. Turn 16. Scope of evidence includes the separate one-item success and three-item failures without generalizing to untested conditions.

9. minimal reproduction. Turn 18. Minimal reproduction is a smaller retained failure example, which has not yet been established by the current observations.

10. evidence bundle. Turn 20. Evidence bundle combines the saved input, actual output, build, action, and frequency needed for a focused investigation.

F Transfer conversation

Page 21

1. Q12

Tester: "The tested build is Q12."

Hana's reported omission is tied specifically to build Q12.

2. three

Developer: "The saved selection contains three items."

The reproducible input is the saved selection of three items.

3. last

Tester: "The last selected item is omitted."

The reported defect removes the final selected item from the export.

4. two

Developer: "The omission occurred in two attempts out of two."

Hana observed the omission in both of the two reported attempts.

03 Briefing and language checks

Choosing cases at boundaries and across rules

03

A Briefing checks / page 22

1. Which whole-number values are accepted by the rule?

D. 1 through 20 inclusive

The stated acceptance range includes both one and twenty.

2. What is missing from 5, 10, and 15?

B. Endpoint and outside-range checks

All three proposed inputs lie inside the accepted range rather than at or beyond its limits.

3. What is known about decimals?

B. Handling is unspecified

The supplied whole-number rule does not specify decimal handling.

D Language checks / page 27

1. Which six-value set checks both endpoints and their immediate neighbors?

D. 0, 1, 2, 19, 20, 21

The correct set includes each endpoint and the nearest whole number on either side.

2. Which expected result is correct?

C. Accept 20 and reject 21

Twenty is included in the stated range, while twenty-one lies above it.

3. Which decimal statement is justified?

B. The rule requires clarification for decimals

The scenario provides no decimal policy or completed decimal checks.

4. Which coverage claim is appropriate?

A. The proposed set addresses the missing edges but has not been executed

Case design identifies intended coverage, but execution evidence is still absent.

03 Conversation answers

Choosing cases at boundaries and across rules

03

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 28-29

- 1. boundary value.** Turn 2. Boundary value identifies an endpoint where the quantity rule changes between acceptance and rejection.
- 2. invalid partition.** Turn 4. An invalid partition contains whole-number inputs outside the accepted one-through-twenty range that the rule says to reject.
- 3. adjacent value.** Turn 6. Adjacent value refers to the nearest whole-number neighbor beside an endpoint, such as zero or two beside one.
- 4. boundary value analysis.** Turn 8. Boundary value analysis concentrates case selection on endpoints and nearby inputs rather than only central accepted values.
- 5. expected result.** Turn 10. Expected result states the outcome required by the rule, which is distinct from an actual result of an executed test.
- 6. inclusive range.** Turn 12. Inclusive range includes both stated endpoints, so one and twenty belong to the accepted set.
- 7. decimal input.** Turn 14. Decimal input falls outside the supplied whole-number rule and needs its own clarified handling policy.
- 8. decision table.** Turn 16. A decision table maps the stated quantity regions to their required outcomes without inventing a decimal rule.
- 9. Case selection.** Turn 18. Case selection concerns which meaningful conditions are checked, not merely how many tests exist.
- 10. coverage.** Turn 20. Coverage describes the conditions addressed by the proposed cases, not proof that every defect is absent or every test has passed.

F Transfer conversation

Page 30

1. 1

Tester: "The accepted lower endpoint is 1."

One is explicitly included as the lower endpoint of the range.

2. 20

Developer: "The accepted upper endpoint is 20."

Twenty is explicitly included as the upper endpoint of the range.

3. 21

Tester: "The whole number immediately above the range is 21."

Twenty-one is the nearest whole number above the accepted upper endpoint.

4. unspecified

Developer: "Decimal handling remains unspecified."

The stated rule provides no handling policy for decimal input.

04 Briefing and language checks

Explaining coverage and change risk

04

A Briefing checks / page 31

1. What did the smoke test cover?

B. Sign-in and opening the account page

The supplied smoke test covers only sign-in and opening the account page.

2. Which paths use the changed formatter?

A. Account-save and existing export

The formatter is shared by account-save and the existing export path.

3. How much time remains?

B. One hour

The scenario allows one hour for additional checking, not unlimited coverage.

D Language checks / page 36

1. Which summary is accurate?

B. Smoke passed for sign-in and page opening; save and export remain untested

The summary preserves the exact checked scope and both missing consumer paths.

2. Why include export in follow-up?

D. It uses the changed formatter

Shared-component usage creates a relevant change-impact question for the existing export path.

3. What does one hour justify?

B. Prioritized checks with disclosed gaps

The timebox limits testing and requires explicit reporting of remaining uncertainty.

4. Which statement confuses plan and evidence?

A. Both paths passed because we intend to check them

Intending to run checks provides no evidence that either path has passed.

04 Conversation answers

Explaining coverage and change risk

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 37-38

- 1. smoke test.** Turn 2. Smoke test describes the small basic check set, not evidence that every changed behavior has been exercised.
- 2. shared component.** Turn 4. Shared component identifies the formatter used by both account-save and export, linking both paths to the modification.
- 3. coverage gap.** Turn 6. Coverage gap names the untested account-save and export behavior that the narrow smoke test did not exercise.
- 4. selection rationale.** Turn 8. Selection rationale explains why the changed formatter's consumers deserve attention within the limited testing time.
- 5. timebox.** Turn 10. Timebox is the one-hour limit on additional work, which does not expand the meaning of the evidence collected.
- 6. change impact.** Turn 12. Change impact concerns the plausible effect of the modified formatter on both consumers without asserting an unmeasured failure probability.
- 7. execution evidence.** Turn 14. Execution evidence consists of actual performed checks and results, not a planned check list.
- 8. residual risk.** Turn 16. Residual risk is the uncertainty or exposure remaining after the checks actually completed, including unfinished planned work.
- 9. test objective.** Turn 18. Test objective specifies the formatted behavior to verify in each consumer path rather than only opening a screen.
- 10. test summary.** Turn 20. Test summary combines checked scope, actual results, proposed follow-up, and limits without claiming complete coverage or release approval.

F Transfer conversation

Page 39

1. smoke

Tester: "The smoke test covered sign-in and opening the page."

The initial smoke test was limited to those two basic actions.

2. formatter

Lead: "Both paths use the changed formatter."

The formatter is shared by account-save and the existing export path.

3. tested

Tester: "Neither account-save nor export has been tested."

The scenario provides no execution result for either consumer path.

4. hour

Lead: "We have one hour for further checking."

One hour is the stated time available for additional testing.

04

05 Briefing and language checks

Investigating inconsistent automated results

A Briefing checks / page 40

1. When does the search check fail?

B. After the cleanup check

The reported failure occurs when cleanup runs before search on T8.

2. What does cleanup remove?

C. The shared sample record search expects

Cleanup deletes the same sample record required by the search check.

3. What changes between the observations?

B. Order and relevant starting state, not code

No code change occurs; the supplied difference concerns test order and shared data.

D Language checks / page 45

1. Which explanation matches the evidence?

D. Cleanup removes data needed by the later search check

The supplied shared-record relationship explains the observed order-dependent interference.

2. What should be compared?

D. Execution order and starting data state

Order and sample-record presence differ between the supplied observations.

3. Which action is not a demonstrated fix?

B. Rerun alone until the check passes

A standalone pass leaves the original suite interference unresolved.

4. What should verification include?

A. The relevant sequence after the data arrangement is corrected

Verification must address the sequence and starting-state problem that produced the failure.

05 Conversation answers

Investigating inconsistent automated results

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 46-47

- 1. execution order.** Turn 2. Execution order is the relevant sequence in which cleanup precedes the failing search check on the same build.
- 2. order dependency.** Turn 4. Order dependency means the search result depends on cleanup having run first and removed its required record.
- 3. rerun.** Turn 6. Rerun is another execution, whose success does not repair the original interference between cleanup and search.
- 4. test data ownership.** Turn 8. Test data ownership assigns responsibility for creating and removing records so one check does not invalidate another's preconditions.
- 5. test isolation.** Turn 10. Test isolation prevents another check's state changes from determining whether search has its required starting data.
- 6. failure evidence.** Turn 12. Failure evidence preserves the observed failing sequence and its conditions even when a different standalone attempt passes.
- 7. precondition.** Turn 14. Precondition is the required sample-record state that must be established before the search check starts.
- 8. interference.** Turn 16. Interference is cleanup's unintended effect on the later search check through removal of its required record.
- 9. verification run.** Turn 18. Verification run checks the revised data arrangement under the relevant sequence instead of assuming the proposed fix succeeded.
- 10. environment state.** Turn 20. Environment state includes the sample-record presence that changes between suite and standalone execution despite an unchanged build.

F Transfer conversation

Page 48

1. T8

Engineer: "Both observations use build T8."

The scenario names T8 for both the suite and standalone observations.

2. cleanup

Tester: "Search fails after cleanup."

Cleanup runs first and removes the record required by search.

3. record

Engineer: "The shared sample record is removed."

The missing sample record is the relevant starting-state difference.

4. isolation

Tester: "A standalone pass does not prove test isolation."

The original shared-data interference remains despite a successful standalone execution.

05

06 Briefing and language checks

Separating impact from scheduling in triage

A Briefing checks / page 49

1. What does the export defect do?

C. Omits the final row in one monthly workflow

The reported functional effect is a missing final export row in the monthly workflow.

2. What will tomorrow's demonstration use?

A. The account page, with no export planned

The demonstration uses the account page, while export is not planned.

3. What decision has already been made?

A. No final repair order or release approval is supplied

The scenario provides discussion facts but no final scheduling or release decision.

D Language checks / page 54

1. Which comparison is accurate?

A. Export loses a row; the typo is widely visible and relevant to tomorrow's demo

The correct comparison preserves functional impact, reach, and event timing separately.

2. What does the demonstration establish?

B. A timing reason to discuss the typo urgently

The planned account-page demonstration affects scheduling relevance, not defect correctness or release authority.

3. Which claim needs more evidence?

B. A workaround exists for the export

No alternative export method or verified workaround is supplied.

4. Which statement avoids a false decision?

D. The repair order and release disposition still need agreement

The scenario gives no final scheduling or authorization decision.

06 Conversation answers

Separating impact from scheduling in triage

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 55-56

- 1. functional impact.** Turn 2. Functional impact identifies what the export defect prevents or corrupts, here completeness of the exported rows.
- 2. Frequency.** Turn 4. Frequency describes how often the monthly workflow occurs and does not determine the seriousness of a missing row by itself.
- 3. business timing.** Turn 6. Business timing captures the upcoming demonstration's relevance to scheduling without equating it with greater functional harm.
- 4. Reach.** Turn 8. Reach describes the affected surfaces, such as every account page, rather than the degree of functional damage.
- 5. defect classification.** Turn 10. Defect classification should follow the actual agreed categories rather than invented labels based only on frequency or visibility.
- 6. Priority.** Turn 12. Priority concerns urgency or work order and does not itself authorize release with an unresolved defect.
- 7. disposition.** Turn 14. Disposition is the specific handling decision for each issue, which must not be replaced by a vague handled status.
- 8. workaround.** Turn 16. Workaround is an alternative way to complete the task, and none has been established for the incomplete export.
- 9. evidence-based comparison.** Turn 18. Evidence-based comparison uses the stated effects and demonstration scope without inventing severity ratings, workarounds, or approvals.
- 10. risk acceptance.** Turn 20. Risk acceptance is an explicit authorized decision about identified exposure, not an inference from urgency or a triage conversation.

F Transfer conversation

Page 57

1. row

Tester: "The export omits the final row."

The supplied export defect concerns the final row of the monthly output.

2. page

Lead: "The typo appears on every account page."

The heading typo has stated visibility across every account page.

3. tomorrow

Tester: "The demonstration is tomorrow."

Tomorrow is the event timing that makes the account-page typo immediately relevant.

4. undecided

Lead: "The final repair order is still undecided."

No final repair sequence is supplied by the scenario's discussion facts.

07 Briefing and language checks

Reporting exploratory findings

A Briefing checks / page 58

1. What was the session's charter?

A. Investigate interrupted profile edits

The stated exploratory goal concerns interruption during profile editing.

2. What happens after a saved edit?

B. Navigating away preserves the value

The saved-edit observation shows persistence after navigating away.

3. What is unresolved?

D. Whether a warning is required for unsaved edits

Warning requirements are unspecified even though the no-warning behavior was observed.

D Language checks / page 63

1. Which report matches the observations?

D. Saved edits persist; unsaved edits are lost without warning

The two stated navigation sequences have different outcomes that must remain separate.

2. What should be requested?

C. Clarification of whether an unsaved-edit warning is required

The missing rule concerns the intended warning behavior for unsaved navigation.

3. Which claim exceeds the evidence?

D. Mobile shows the same result

Mobile was explicitly not explored, so its behavior is unknown.

4. Why avoid calling this a confirmed warning defect now?

C. The applicable warning requirement is unspecified

A confirmed requirement violation needs an applicable expectation, which is missing for the warning.

07 Conversation answers

Reporting exploratory findings

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 64-65

- 1. test charter.** Turn 2. Test charter names the session's purpose, investigating interrupted profile edits, rather than a claim of complete feature coverage.
- 2. saved state.** Turn 4. Saved state refers to the value retained after the completed save, which persisted through the observed navigation.
- 3. observation.** Turn 6. Observation reports the actual loss of the unsaved change without warning, without inventing an intended-behavior rule.
- 4. requirement gap.** Turn 8. Requirement gap identifies the missing warning rule needed to classify the observed behavior against intended expectations.
- 5. evidence trail.** Turn 10. Evidence trail connects the question to the recorded action sequence and outcome so another person can investigate it.
- 6. usability concern.** Turn 12. Usability concern can flag a potentially confusing user experience before an unspecified warning policy is resolved.
- 7. scope exclusion.** Turn 14. Scope exclusion records that mobile behavior was not explored and prevents the observed result being generalized to it.
- 8. timebox.** Turn 16. Timebox is the twenty-minute duration of the investigation, not a measure proving complete coverage of interruptions.
- 9. confirmed defect.** Turn 18. Confirmed defect requires evidence of a departure from an applicable expectation, which the missing warning rule does not yet provide.
- 10. session outcome.** Turn 20. Session outcome summarizes the explored behaviors and remaining questions without claiming all profile edits or mobile behavior were tested.

F Transfer conversation

Page 66

1. minutes

Tester: "The session lasted twenty minutes."

Twenty minutes is the stated duration of the exploratory session.

2. saved

Analyst: "The saved edit persisted after navigation."

The value remained when navigation followed a completed save.

3. warning

Tester: "The unsaved edit was lost without a warning."

No warning appeared in the observed unsaved-navigation sequence.

4. Mobile

Analyst: "Mobile behavior was not explored."

Mobile is explicitly outside the behavior explored in this session.

08 Briefing and language checks

Giving a release-evidence handover

A Briefing checks / page 67

1. How are the ten checks divided?

D. Seven passed, one failed, two blocked

The stated totals are seven passes, one failure, and two blocked checks.

2. Why is the critical-path criterion unmet?

D. One critical check is blocked and unexecuted

The criterion requires execution and review of every critical-path check, including the blocked one.

3. Who owns the release decision?

D. Mara

Mara is explicitly named as the owner of the unresolved release decision.

D Language checks / page 72

1. How many checks have executed?

C. Eight

Seven passed checks plus one failed check equals eight executed checks.

2. What is seven divided by ten in this report?

A. Passes as a share of planned checks

Ten is the planned total, so seven of ten describes passes against planned checks.

3. Which criterion statement is justified?

C. It is unmet because a critical check remains unexecuted

Every critical-path check must execute and be reviewed, and one remains blocked.

4. Which handover is complete?

A. Q20: seven passed, one failed, two blocked including one critical; criterion unmet; Mara's decision pending

The complete handover includes all statuses, the critical gap, criterion consequence, and decision ownership.

08 Conversation answers

Giving a release-evidence handover

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 73-74

1. status breakdown. Turn 2. Status breakdown accounts separately for all ten planned checks instead of hiding failure and blockers behind the pass count.

2. exit criterion. Turn 4. Exit criterion requires execution and review of every critical-path check, which the blocked critical check prevents us from satisfying.

3. blocked check. Turn 6. Blocked check means execution is prevented by a missing prerequisite, not that the expected result was met or violated.

4. execution status. Turn 8. Execution status separates the eight checks that ran from the two that could not run due to missing data.

5. denominator. Turn 10. Denominator determines whether the reported pass proportion uses ten planned checks or eight executed checks.

6. failed check. Turn 12. Failed check records an executed expectation mismatch and must remain visible separately from the unavailable-data blockers.

7. blocked dependency. Turn 14. Blocked dependency is the unavailable sample data that must be resolved before the affected checks can execute.

8. Review status. Turn 16. Review status is a separate requirement from execution under the stated criterion, so running a check alone is not sufficient.

9. release authority. Turn 18. Release authority remains with Mara, and the evidence report does not itself grant approval or an exception.

10. readiness evidence. Turn 20. Readiness evidence presents actual results and unmet conditions for the decision maker without claiming release approval.

F Transfer conversation

Page 75

1. Seven

Tester: "Seven checks passed."

The scenario establishes seven passed checks out of the ten planned.

2. One

Owner: "One check failed."

One executed check failed and must remain distinct from blocked checks.

3. Two

Tester: "Two checks are blocked by missing sample data."

Two checks could not execute because their required sample data was unavailable.

4. pending

Owner: "The release decision remains pending."

Mara has not made the release decision, and the report is not approval.

Find the move you need

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

01 Agreeing the expected result

Locate the ambiguity: The two examples disagree at exactly twenty-four hours.

Ask the precise question: Should equality be accepted or rejected?

Request a usable expectation: We need one expected result for this input.

Full phrase set: pages 7-8 | Dialogue: pages 10-11

02 Making a failure reproducible

Identify the build: I observed this on Q12.

State the omission: The last selected item is missing from the output.

Explain the difference: That uses a different selection size.

Full phrase set: pages 16-17 | Dialogue: pages 19-20

03 Choosing cases at boundaries and across rules

State the domain: The rule concerns whole-number quantities.

Name the lower endpoint: One should be accepted.

Add inside neighbors: Two and nineteen check just inside the limits.

Full phrase set: pages 25-26 | Dialogue: pages 28-29

04 Explaining coverage and change risk

State the narrow success: Sign-in and opening the account page passed.

Expose the gap: Neither consumer path has been tested.

Keep a proposal provisional: Those checks are planned, not completed.

Full phrase set: pages 34-35 | Dialogue: pages 37-38

Keep the conversation productive

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

05 Investigating inconsistent automated results

Identify the build: Both observations are on T8.

Preserve the code fact: No code changed between those observations.

Request the starting state: Was the required record present when search began?

Full phrase set: pages 43-44 | Dialogue: pages 46-47

06 Separating impact from scheduling in triage

Name the export effect: The export omits its final row.

State tomorrow's scope: The demonstration uses the account page.

Avoid inflating: Broad visibility does not automatically mean greater functional harm.

Full phrase set: pages 52-53 | Dialogue: pages 55-56

07 Reporting exploratory findings

Name the charter: The session investigated interrupted profile edits.

Separate the unsaved path: Navigating away during an unsaved edit lost the change.

Request the intended behavior: Should leaving an unsaved edit trigger a warning?

Full phrase set: pages 61-62 | Dialogue: pages 64-65

08 Giving a release-evidence handover

Identify the candidate: This handover concerns Q20.

Give failures: One check failed.

State the consequence: That criterion is not currently met.

Full phrase set: pages 70-71 | Dialogue: pages 73-74

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

acceptance criterion	refine the acceptance criterion	5
acceptance region	define the acceptance region	24
account-save path	exercise the account-save path	32
actual output	attach the actual output	14
actual result	record the actual result	5
adjacent value	test the adjacent value	23
affected workflow	name the affected workflow	51
ambiguity	resolve an ambiguity	5
assumption	label an assumption	6
attachment	add an attachment	15
blocked check	identify blocked checks	68
blocked dependency	resolve the blocked dependency	69
boundary	test the boundary	5
boundary value	select a boundary value	23
boundary value analysis	apply boundary value analysis	23
build identifier	include the build identifier	14
business rule	confirm the business rule	6
business timing	explain business timing	50
cannot reproduce	qualify cannot reproduce	15
case selection	explain case selection	24
change impact	assess change impact	32
clarification request	raise a clarification request	6
cleanup	limit cleanup scope	41
confirmation run	perform a confirmation run	15

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

confirmed defect distinguish a confirmed defect	60
consumer path test the consumer path	32
continuous integration investigate the CI result	42
contradiction identify a contradiction	5
cosmetic defect classify a cosmetic defect carefully	50
counterexample assess a counterexample	15
coverage claim limit the coverage claim	33
coverage gap report the coverage gap	32
coverage item identify the coverage item	24
criterion exception document a criterion exception	69
critical path identify the critical path	68
customer demonstration prepare for the customer demonstration	50
data completeness verify data completeness	50
debrief hold a debrief	59
decimal input clarify decimal input	24
decision owner identify the decision owner	51
decision pending keep decision pending	69
decision record preserve the decision record	6
decision rule map the decision rule	24
decision table build a decision table	24
defect classification explain defect classification	51
defect report submit a defect report	14
defer document a decision to defer	51
denominator state the denominator	14

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

denominator specify the denominator	69
dependency mapping use dependency mapping	33
deterministic setup create deterministic setup	42
disposition record the disposition	51
environment detail preserve environment details	14
environment state compare environment state	42
equality case clarify the equality case	5
equivalence partition identify an equivalence partition	23
evidence bundle prepare an evidence bundle	15
evidence handover prepare the evidence handover	69
evidence trail retain the evidence trail	60
evidence-based comparison make an evidence-based comparison	51
example reconcile conflicting examples	6
exclusive limit distinguish an exclusive limit	5
execution evidence distinguish execution evidence	33
execution order record execution order	41
execution status distinguish execution status	68
exit criterion assess the exit criterion	68
expected output state the expected output	14
expected result agree the expected result	5
exploratory testing conduct exploratory testing	59
export path check the export path	32
failed check report the failed check	68
failure evidence retain failure evidence	42

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

false alarm investigate a false alarm	42
finding report a finding	59
flaky test investigate a flaky test	41
follow-up check schedule a follow-up check	33
follow-up question record a follow-up question	60
formatter trace formatter usage	32
frequency state workflow frequency	50
functional impact assess functional impact	33
functional impact explain functional impact	50
handoff note prepare the handoff note	15
inclusive limit specify an inclusive limit	5
inclusive range specify an inclusive range	23
input domain state the input domain	24
input parity establish input parity	15
interference remove test interference	42
interior value distinguish an interior value	23
interruption investigate an interruption	60
invalid partition cover an invalid partition	23
log excerpt include a log excerpt	15
lower bound check the lower bound	23
minimal reproduction seek a minimal reproduction	15
mobile coverage avoid assuming mobile coverage	60
navigation away describe navigation away	59
observation separate observation from interpretation	59

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

off-by-one error detect an off-by-one error	23
omission report the final-item omission	14
open defect retain the open defect	69
order dependency expose an order dependency	41
out-of-range value reject an out-of-range value	24
pass rate qualify the pass rate	68
pass/fail judgment defer the pass/fail judgment	6
passed check report passed checks	68
persistence check persistence	59
planned check count planned checks	68
postcondition define the postcondition	6
precondition state the precondition	6
precondition establish the precondition	41
priority set priority	50
quarantine review quarantine status	42
reach distinguish reach from harm	50
readiness evidence present readiness evidence	69
regression testing prioritize regression testing	32
rejection region cover the rejection region	24
release authority respect release authority	69
release blocker identify a release blocker	51
release candidate identify the release candidate	68
release disposition record the release disposition	69
release recommendation qualify a release recommendation	33

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

repair order agree the repair order	50
reproduction frequency report reproduction frequency	14
reproduction steps follow the reproduction steps	14
requirement clarify the requirement	5
requirement gap raise the requirement gap	60
requirement owner consult the requirement owner	6
rerun qualify a rerun result	42
residual risk disclose residual risk	33
review status report review status	68
risk acceptance distinguish risk acceptance	51
risk register update the risk register	69
risk-based testing propose risk-based testing	32
sample data obtain sample data	68
sample record preserve the sample record	41
saved selection reuse the saved selection	14
saved state verify saved state	59
scheduling constraint state the scheduling constraint	51
scope boundary respect the scope boundary	6
scope exclusion list a scope exclusion	60
scope of evidence limit the scope of evidence	15
screen recording attach a screen recording	15
selection rationale explain the selection rationale	33
selection size compare selection size	14
session document the session	59

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

session notes preserve session notes	59
session outcome summarize the session outcome	60
setup verify setup	41
severity assess severity	50
shared component identify the shared component	32
shared fixture isolate a shared fixture	41
smoke test pass the smoke test	32
stakeholder impact assess stakeholder impact	51
standalone run compare a standalone run	41
state leakage detect state leakage	41
state transition record the state transition	60
status breakdown give the status breakdown	69
suite run inspect the suite run	42
teardown review teardown	41
test basis review the test basis	6
test case specify the test case	24
test charter define the test charter	59
test completion assess test completion	68
test data ownership define test data ownership	42
test fixture share the test fixture	14
test isolation restore test isolation	41
test objective define the test objective	33
test oracle establish the test oracle	5
test priority set test priority	32

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

test scope state the test scope	33
test summary write the test summary	33
threshold name the threshold	5
timebox use a one-hour timebox	32
timebox respect the timebox	59
traceability maintain traceability	6
triage bring a defect to triage	50
unexecuted check disclose the unexecuted check	69
unique test data use unique test data	42
unsaved change identify an unsaved change	59
unspecified behavior flag unspecified behavior	24
untested path identify an untested path	33
unverified condition identify an unverified condition	15
upper bound check the upper bound	23
usability concern record a usability concern	60
user journey describe the user journey	60
valid partition sample the valid partition	23
validation message check the validation message	24
verification run perform a verification run	42
visibility describe visibility	50
waiver record a waiver	51
warning prompt clarify the warning prompt	60
whole number enter a whole number	23
workaround verify a workaround	51

Original cases. Clear boundaries.

These are original fictional teaching conversations, not transcripts of real workers. Names, figures, organizations, and incidents are invented. Sources support terminology and communication aims, not the fictional results or an endorsement of this book.

[1] International Software Testing Qualifications Board. Foundation Level Syllabus v4.0.1.

[Open the original source](#)

Terminology reference for boundaries, exploratory sessions, and reporting. Copyright in the syllabus belongs to its authors and ISTQB; these cases are original. Checked 1 October 2026.

[2] pytest Documentation. Flaky Tests.

[Open the original source](#)

Background on shared state and order-dependent results. The fictional cleanup and search scenario does not prescribe a particular framework. Checked 1 October 2026.

[3] MDN Web Docs. When and How to File Bugs with Browsers.

[Open the original source](#)

Context for reproducible examples, versions, and expected versus actual results. No source code examples are reproduced. Checked 1 October 2026.

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